



VESTIUM

December 16th, 2024

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1.0 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

1.1 FOUNDING TEAM



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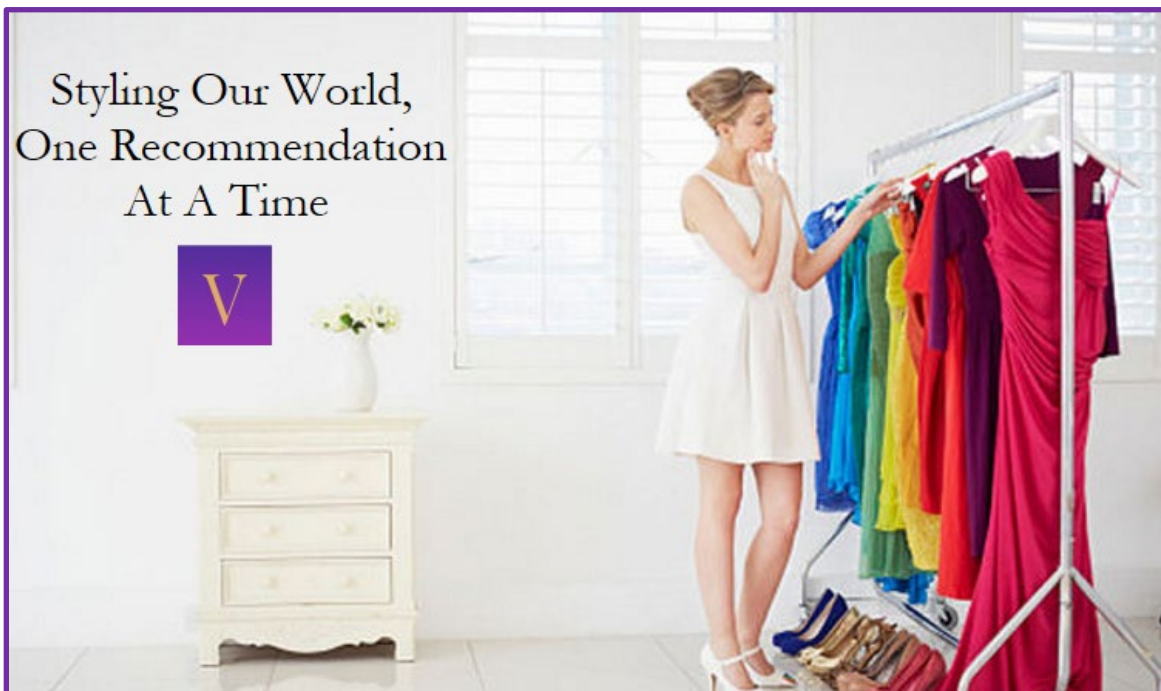
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1.2 MISSION STATEMENT



1.3 OBJECTIVES

Vestium seeks to enrich the lives of individuals by allowing them to maximize their closets and feel confident in themselves and their clothes - all while contributing to minimizing fast fashion and overconsumption. Through careful financial analysis, Vestium affirms that it will become a \$1,000,000 annual profit generating business by year 5 of operation. Past year 5, Vestium is expected to exponentially grow in both its services to others as well as its profitability, as more people will continue to use our incredible application. Within the first 5 years, Vestium seeks to have a robust and fully functioning app with integrated artificial intelligence. Furthermore, by year 5 we expect to have over 25 employees catering to the continued improvement of Vestium and a market share of 30% in the fashion and technology app space. Furthermore, we expect to have over 1.5 million downloads across the world, and over 35 advertising partnerships with other companies who will leverage our app for advertising space in return for compensation to our company.

COMPANY DESCRIPTION

1.4 CONTACT INFORMATION

Name of Company: Vestium

Address of Company: 117 Wellington St. East Aurora, ONL4G 1H9

Phone Number: (647) 272-7880

Fax Number: (289) 747-7477

Email Address: contact@vestium.com

Website: www.vestium.com

1.5 BACKGROUND

Vestium was created by 3 friends who are passionate about the emerging artificial intelligence and clothing industries. Our team came up with Vestium after witnessing the struggles many adolescents and teens face on a daily basis. Often, individuals are unsure of what to wear - even with a closet full of clothes. Vestium wanted to prove that people can get more out of their existing articles of clothing than they think - and don't have to keep buying more pieces just to stay looking fresh. Our team has also seen the issue of not being able to decide what to wear for the day, but we wondered if that could all change with the use of artificial intelligence. Thus, our team was motivated and strived to come up with a revolutionary app, which meshes the worlds of AI and fashion, bringing the digital to the real, to get individuals ready for their date, school, work, or a fancy meal.

Our company will be located in Aurora, Ontario, at unit 4 - 117 Wellington St. East Aurora (Aurora Village), Ontario L4G1H9. This location is ideal due to its close proximity to Vestium's major shareholders, founders, lawyers and bankers. Furthermore, given that Vestium is primarily a software-based company, a large workplace is not needed, as work can sometimes be completed remotely. However, having a homebase can lead to increased productivity and proficiency. Furthermore, this in person office location allows the Vestium team to host clients, investors and hold meetings in this space - as well as create and boost the social morale within the company by allowing our employees to interact in person with one another.

Vestium will be a private corporation. This option was selected for a variety of reasons. Firstly, our team would not be personally liable for any debt or financial occurrences. In addition, as a corporation we will have greater access to funds and investment opportunities. This is great for us as,

we will likely require a sufficient amount of funds in order to get our idea running and become profitable. Furthermore, being a corporation minimizes our tax obligations and provides tax benefits and incentives. To see a full timeline of Vestium's first year please see Appendix 1.

Vestium has a strong team already built to help start this venture. Internally, Vestium's team consists of our CEO, Ethan Fleming; our COO, Miraj Siddiqui; our CFO Liam Milenov; and our CTO, John Qing. Externally, Vestium will contract lawyer, Jason Allen; banker, Reza Aghdasi; accountant, Drake McCleave; and real estate agent, Eddie Donan. Every individual's role is critical to the success of our company, but Vestium's three founding members believe that the individuals we recruited have the skills to help Vestium grow into a multimillion dollar company within the next few years. To see more detailed information of those Vestium has contracted please see Appendix 2.

1.6 CURRENT SITUATION

The most exploitable opportunity in the market today is clearly the fact that none of the other companies in this industry provide any kind of interpersonal connections between their users. The competition in this market is relatively small and because they aren't high-quality products, they mostly compete on price and the ease of use of their apps. Because of their low-quality apps, ours will stand out as a more luxurious and detailed option that includes social features to share and connect with like-minded friends. It will also allow for access to the content created by our AI software which will provide users the chance to generate new outfits.

1.7 PRODUCT/SERVICE DESCRIPTION

Every morning billions of people worldwide have to decide what to wear for the day. Choosing an outfit daily can be quite stressful for many who need to balance factors such as feeling comfortable, looking good, being dressed appropriately, and not being too hot or cold. Ultimately, people want to look good and to feel good, as many are very conscious of what others think of their outfits. Having to deal with this stress everyday can be quite taxing and results in many resorting to wearing the same few clothes, cycling through them every week, with half the clothes in their closet never touched. Finding a solution to this problem will not only save people time but will save them unnecessary worry and stress, and with the choice of an outfit made easier, their lives will become easier.

This problem is most significant in both first class families and the downtown verve, which will be explained under the target market/psychographic section of this business plan. This demographic deeply cares about how they look and what others think about them, meaning they put the most thought each day into what they will wear. Furthermore, it's this demographic that will be most willing to adopt Vestium's solution to their problems as they are open to change and to new trends. Therefore, if Vestium can prove itself as a solution to this group, it will have the opportunity to start a new trend, creating a wide-reaching and long-lasting influence.

To solve this problem, Vestium will create a new three-pronged approach in the form of a new phone application that will combine a digital marketplace, AI fashion advisor, and outfit-sharing social media component into one app. Vestium will act as a catalog for all of one's clothes, which can be added to by simply taking a picture or finding the article of clothing online. In the morning users will simply input what occasion they are dressing for (work, night out with friends, etc.) and the Vestium

AI will search their closet to put together the perfect outfit for the occasion ensuring that weather conditions, societal expectations, and personal expectations are accounted for in the outfit decision.

The recommended outfit will be placed on a digital recreation of the consumer's body, created using photos taken by the consumer's phone, so the user can see how the outfit will look on them.

Furthermore, Vestium's app will incorporate a social media component allowing you to share your clothing catalogs with friends. Friends will be able to view each other's digital closets, see where articles of clothing were bought, and will be able to buy pieces of clothing for themselves by using Vestium's built-in digital marketplace which will be partnered with top clothing brands worldwide and will have access links to those suppliers Vestium may not yet be partnered with to ensure a user can search for and buy any piece of clothing they may see on our app. For a visual example of Vestium in action please see Appendix 3.

Vestium is one of a kind, setting itself far apart from any other competitors which will ensure Vestium quickly gains a strong market share. While there are other digital closets in the marketplace, Vestium is the only one with built-in AI to suggest an outfit for any occasion based on what one has in their closet. Furthermore, Vestium's social media and digital marketplace features are like those never before seen on any other app or website. Giving users the ability to view exactly what clothing their friends own and then the option to directly buy that article of clothing has never before been done. Vestium's social features will also attract celebrities to share their wardrobes with the world and will draw in millions of fans across the world who want to take a closer look at where the stars they see on stage buy their clothing, with the chance to get it for themselves as well.

As of now, the Vestium app is in a Beta Testing phase. There is a functional app created by our CTO John Qing, however the app is consistently being tweaked and fixed to become better. The login and information storage component of the app is functional, and the social media aspect is in working order. However, the AI portion is still being developed as we work through the numerous intricate details required to form and train it effectively. Furthermore, our marketplace is able to showcase products, but we have not yet signed any major commissary based deals with major retail and fashion brands. To continue to develop and build the app, more coding is required in order to refine and better the app. This will require more funds and insight from coders and technological developers - which is why we are appealing to the McEwen Competition Judges seeking insight and investment.

1.8 PROPRIETARY POSITION

After conducting research through Canada's Business Registries, we found the name Vestium has not yet been taken by any Canadian companies. With that in mind, Vestium was officially registered through the Government Of Canada as our business name on Thursday, October 17th, 2024. Consequently, we also patented the name Vestium on the same date to ensure we are protected against potential problems that may arise in the future. As our product is a smartphone application, there is no standardized testing that it must undergo nor regulatory standards that it must meet. However, Vestium will have to maintain Canada's digital privacy laws by requesting user permission before using our app. To ensure that we are operating completely within the law and are free from liability, Vestium will hire lawyers to assist with our start-up, user agreements, and trademarks.

1.9 FINANCIAL REQUIREMENTS

The total startup and operation costs for our business in year one will amount to \$421,295 in expenses. This includes all of the categories shown in [Figure 1] on the right-hand side. We have already accounted for \$425,000 of investment money and have “broken even” for our projected year one expenses. This will be paid for through the \$200,000 dollars from investors, \$200,000 from a loan and our personal financing, and a \$25,000 dollar grant.

Operating Costs		
Salaries	\$ 150,000.00	/year
App developer salary	\$ 86,736.00	/year
App Development	\$ 50,000.00	one time
Online marketing	\$ 30,000.00	/year
Legal	\$ 24,000.00	/year
Loan Payback	\$ 20,000.00	/year
HQ Rent	\$ 10,200.00	/year
Experiential Marketing	\$ 10,000.00	/use
Data storage	\$ 10,000.00	one time
Consumer Research	\$ 10,000.00	one time
App Maintenance	\$ 7,500.00	/year
Servers	\$ 5,000.00	one time
Computers x4	\$ 4,000.00	one time
Internet	\$ 2,400.00	/year
Insurance	\$ 1,000.00	/year
Business registration	\$ 360.00	one time
App Store Fee	\$ 99.00	/year
Total Costs Y1	\$ 421,295.00	
Total Costs Y2 +	\$ 321,935.00	

Figure 1 – Total Startup and Operations Costs for Vestium in Year One

2.0 SOCIAL IMPACT

2.1 PROBLEM

As the world has rapidly developed over the last century, the environment has been left behind. Many see only one cause of this problem, the burning of fossil fuels, yet in reality, there are many more contributors aiding climate change. One of the most notable? Fast fashion. Fast fashion refers to, “cheaply produced and priced garments that copy the latest catwalk styles and get pumped quickly through stores in order to maximize on current trends.”¹ In other words, cheap clothing is mass-produced, and has an extremely short lifespan, leading to much of it ending up in landfills.

Fast fashion impacts the environment in three main ways: water, microplastics, and energy. Firstly, fast fashion utilizes massive amounts of water. Over 700 gallons of water are required to produce just one cotton shirt, and over 2000 gallons of water are required to produce one pair of jeans.² Fast fashion has led to a significant increase in all types of clothing being produced, meaning that millions of gallons of water are wasted when they don't need to be. Furthermore, textile dying is also the world's second-largest polluter of water.³ Water leftover from dying processes is often dumped into ditches, rivers, or streams. Secondly, fast fashion significantly adds to the microplastics in the world's water supply. A 2017 report on primary microplastics in oceans found that 35% of all microplastics come from the creation of synthetic materials (eg. polyester) that are used to create

¹ <https://earth.org/fast-fashions-detrimental-effect-on-the-environment/>

² <https://earth.org/fast-fashions-detrimental-effect-on-the-environment/>

³ <https://www.businessinsider.com/fast-fashion-environmental-impact-pollution-emissions-waste-water-2019-10#all-in-all-the-fashion-industry-is-responsible-for-20-of-all-industrial-water-pollution-worldwide-21>

clothing.⁴ Finally, the creation of textiles requires a significant amount of energy. By mass producing cheap clothing, lots of energy is wasted, requiring the world to produce more which is often done through non-environmentally friendly means.

As a society, if we are not able to solve the fast fashion crisis, the effects on our environment will be detrimental. As such Vestium is committed to helping provide a solution to ensure we leave a sustainable world for future generations.

2.2 BENEFICIARIES AND VISION

As of 2024, most “fast fashion” clothes exporters are from developing countries across Asia, including India, Bangladesh, Vietnam, China, Indonesia, and Cambodia.⁵ However, the cause of this problem also falls on countries all across the world such as the UK, the United States, India, and Canada. Wealthy consumers from these countries often buy new clothing at extremely fast rates, which encourages the Asian countries listed above to continue to produce new clothes. Additionally, as fast fashion is polluting the environment, every single person in the world is affected by this problem. Fast fashion contributes to detrimental changes to the environment such as lower air quality, lower water quality, killing of plants and animals, and rising ocean levels. Every time fast fashion item is purchased, it slightly worsens these problems, and on the scale that new clothing is currently being produced, humanity is headed in the wrong direction. Therefore, the entire world and its people will benefit from a solution to this problem. By reducing the amount of cheap clothing manufactured and preventing

⁴ <https://portals.iucn.org/library/node/46622>

⁵ https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fast_fashion#:~:text=Most%20fast%20fashion%20clothes%20exporters,-China%2C%20Indonesia%2C%20and%20Cambodia.

fast fashion, we will give the environment the ability to start to heal itself, eradicating the consequences mentioned above.

2.3 SOLUTION AND IMPACT PROPOSITION

To do our part to help solve this problem Vestium will help people realize what they have in their closet may already be enough to meet their fashion requirements. Fast fashion is only able to thrive due to consumers constantly buying cheap clothing that they will rarely wear. With our AI outfit suggestions, Vestium will show our users the endless possibilities for outfits that they have sitting in their own closets. Our app will lead our users to find joy in what they already own, preventing them from buying new clothing as frequently as they do today. Not only will this save our users money, but it will shrink the fast fashion industry, lessening its effect on the environment.

Some set up on the user's part will be required for our app to make fashion recommendations. Firstly, users will need to ensure that they upload every piece of clothing into Vestium's interface. This will give the Vestium AI enough pieces of clothing to consistently build unique outfits, keeping our users style fresh. Additionally, users will have to use our app often to ensure that their own outfit choices don't make them feel burnt out by what they have in their wardrobe. Finally, Vestium will include an educational component of our app. Within the app consumers can watch videos teaching them about fast fashion and the importance of not "impulse buying" clothes. These videos will be mandatory to use the app and will be quite short but packed full of information, so they don't annoy users.

2.4 KEY INDICATORS AND EVALUATION

Not only will Vestium prevent new fast fashion purchases by showing consumers what they have in their own closets, but it will change consumer behaviour as a whole. Fast fashion is not a problem that many are educated on. By using Vestium to educate consumers on the issue, people will better understand the impact they have on the environment when they purchase new clothing, leading to them doing so less. By purchasing less new clothing, fast fashion producers will create fewer new clothes, helping to lessen the impact on the environment.

A marquee component of the Vestium app is its ability to catalog a user's full wardrobe online. As consumers buy new clothing and add that clothing to their online catalog, Vestium will be able to evaluate each user's individual impact on fast fashion. This will help Vestium evaluate its social impact on this pressing issue, on an individual basis. As such, the Vestium app can tailor its educational ads versus normal ads depending on the user. A user who tends to buy more clothing will see more educational ads, helping to further their education on fast fashion and how to prevent it. All in all, Vestium will be able to measure each user's impact, giving Vestium data to improve its social impact as a whole.

2.5 PARTNERS AND OUTREACH

Across the world, there are currently many not-for-profits working towards addressing fast fashion. The biggest eight that target fast fashion specifically are Fashion Revolution, Remake, Clean Clothes Campaign, Fair Wear Foundation, Centre For Sustainable Fashion, Slow Fashion Movement,

Slow Factory, and Sustainable Fashion Forum.⁶ These organizations seek to both support workers in the fast fashion industry and to protect the environment from fast fashion. Vestium will work with these organizations in many different ways. Firstly, we will collaborate with them to produce the educational aspect of Vestium's app. This will include educational videos, facts, and news articles relating to fast fashion. Furthermore, Vestium will sponsor events that these organizations run. These sponsorships will not only give Vestium publicity and advertising but will also help these organizations run great events to better educate the public and protect the environment from the impacts of fast fashion.

2.6 INPUTS AND COSTS

As Vestium is going to partner with many of the not-for-profit organizations mentioned, there will be no cost to produce the educational aspects of the Vestium app. All of the organizations listed already have many educational resources that Vestium will be able to repurpose to educate its users. The not-for-profits will be happy to lend these resources as it will provide them with free publicity on the Vestium app. Additionally, implementing these resources into the Vestium app will add no additional cost as Vestium will employ full time web developers, as mentioned under the human resources section of this report. However, it is important to note that sponsoring events that these organizations run will come at an additional cost. These costs will be well worth it due to the positive impact the money will have on the environment and improving fast fashion, as well as the publicity Vestium will receive, which will increase the number of users on the Vestium app.

⁶ <https://thesensiblefay.com/blog/2022/8-sustainable-fashion-organizations-to-support>

2.7 FUNDING AND RESOURCES

As Vestium's solution to the fast fashion problem comes at no cost, it will require no funding. While sponsorships will cost money, that will be a part of Vestium's advertising budget, meaning that no funding will be required for the sponsorships either. However, the Vestium app will incorporate a donation system where users can donate funds to support the various organizations that Vestium will partner with. This money will go towards better educating the world on fast fashion, preventing the creation of new, cheap clothing, and will help protect the environment. In summary, Vestium highly values the environment and as a company will do everything in its power to help educate, prevent, and protect in regard to the fast fashion industry and the environment.

3.0 MARKET ANALYSIS

INDUSTRY ANALYSIS

3.1 INDUSTRY OVERVIEW

As both the fashion and technology industries continue to excel in growth and performance, we seek to interweave the two together into a fabric, bridging the two. As such Vestium will be entering both the fashion and the technology industries, but more specifically the Global Apparel Market and the AI App Sector. The AI App Sector reached \$1.8 billion in revenue in 2023 and is expected to reach \$18.8 billion by 2028.⁷ Currently, over 200 million individuals access AI-backed apps. The Global Apparel Market is estimated to be valued at \$1.79 trillion in 2024 accounting for 1.63% of the world's GDP.⁸ The market and industry is expected to rapidly grow, with an expected annual growth of 9.36% by 2027.⁹ These two different industries can be integrated into the Digital Fashion Industry, the true industry that Vestium is entering. In this Digital Fashion Industry, we see an already large market, with room for staggering growth. The global digital clothing market was valued at \$498.7 million in 2021 and is expected to reach \$4.8 billion by 2031.¹⁰ Vestium will be able to capitalize on this immense growth, and by gaining even a small slice of this growing market, the company will be extremely profitable. AI is still fairly new to the world and will only continue to develop, grow, and become more

⁷ <https://www.businessofapps.com/data/ai-app-market/#:~:text=The%20AI%20app%20sector%20reached,reach%20%2418.8%20billion%20by%202028.>

⁸ <https://www.uniformmarket.com/statistics/global-apparel-industry-statistics#:~:text=The%20global%20apparel%20market%20is%20estimated%20to%20be%20valued%20at,States%20a mounts%20to%20%24358.70%20billion.>

⁹ <https://www.netguru.com/blog/fashion-industry-trends-2030>

¹⁰ <https://thefword.ai/the-rise-of-digital-fashion-market-and-monetization/#:~:text=The-%20Digital%20Fashion%20Market,-As%20we%20all&text=Their%20style%20becomes%20a%20boundless,-2031%2C%20according%20to%20the%20report.>

capable. By capitalizing on AI's growth and combining it with one of the world's biggest industries Vestium is bound for success.

3.2 INDUSTRY TRENDS AND GROWTH PATTERNS

The reason for this great estimated growth is due to cultural shifts and outlooks on the fashion industry. For example, we are now witnessing shifts towards more sustainable and environmentally friendly practices in consumerism, especially when it comes to fast fashion. Fast fashion is a design, manufacturing, and marketing method focused on rapidly producing high volumes of clothing. Fast fashion garment production leverages trend replication and low-quality materials (like synthetic fabrics) in order to bring inexpensive styles to the end consumer.¹¹ Although the end consumer is able to save some money, the impact to the rest of the world is heavy. According to the BBC, the fast fashion industry is responsible for approximately 10% of global carbon emissions and 20% of wastewater.¹² And that only accounts for the production of fast fashion products. On the back end, 85% of all fast fashion textiles go to landfills each year.¹³ This harms the planet on multiple levels, further endangering and harming entire ecosystems, and contributes to the alarming issue of climate change and global warming. Fast fashion does not just stop there. It also places a significant burden on humans. Fast fashion companies have been able to sell their low-quality products inexpensively thanks to the utilization of cheap labor across the developing world in factories known as “sweatshops”. In these production facilities, workers are subjected to harsh conditions and unjust treatment. In addition

¹¹ <https://goodonyou.eco/what-is-fast-fashion/>

¹² <https://www.plasticcollective.co/how-fast-fashion-is-bad-for-the-environment/#:~:text=As%20highlighted%20by%20the%20BBC,and%2020%25%20of%20waste%20water.>

¹³ <https://earth.org/fast-fashions-detrimental-effect-on-the-environment/#:~:text=The%20Dark%20Side%20of%20Fast,go%20to%20dumps%20each%20year.>

to the factories and sweatshops which already harm individuals, the low-quality clothes have negative effects on consumers as well. According to the Centre for Biological Diversity: “Garments contain a variety of harmful chemicals including PFAS, azo dyes, phthalates, and formaldehyde.”¹⁴ These chemicals come with risks of irritation; respiratory, developmental, and reproductive problems; and certain cancers.” Due to the recognition and realization of the grave issues many fashion companies pose, consumers have started to gravitate towards brands with more ethical practices. Nowadays, we are seeing a trend of people seeking fair- trade products and pieces that minimize harm to the environment. Another strong trend that the market is realizing is digital fashion. As AI integrates further into society, fashion is bound to be integrated with AI as well. As of 2024, the industry size of AI in fashion is assessed at USD 3 Billion and is expected to reach USD 91 billion by the end of 2036.¹⁵ Based on estimates, AI and fashion will tether together and branch off into a new industry which is expected to grow as an extension of both industries tremendously. AI can play a plethora of roles in the fashion industry - which Vestium is seeking to demonstrate to the masses. Currently, we are seeing AI being leveraged for virtual-try-ons of clothing by fashion brands. In addition, AI is being utilized to personalize and tailor the shopping experience to customers - especially online shoppers. As the social landscape continues to change, we will see AI become further integrated in the fashion world - and Vestium is here to be a bastion for that.

¹⁴ <https://fashinnovation.nyc/blog/>

¹⁵ <https://www.researchnester.com/reports/ai-in-fashion-market/6296#:~:text=AI%20in%20Fashion%20Market%20size%20was%20valued%20at%20USD%201.6,assessed%20at%20USD%203%20Billion.>

COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

3.3 DIRECT COMPETITORS

Cladwell - (\$6.8 Million USD)

Cladwell is an American company focused on wardrobe creation as well as the mixing and matching of outfits. Although based in the United States, Cladwell's services are offered worldwide through their online app. The app mainly targets consumers who value minimalism and sustainability in their lives and are looking to maximize the utility of their clothing. Cladwell also appeals to consumers who want to simplify their wardrobe choices and remove any potential waste by building smaller, more versatile collections of clothes rather than a large assortment. Cladwell positions itself in the market as an ideal tool for those interested in maintaining a small capsule closet (a closet with few pieces of clothing) while also being an effective way to reduce spending on clothes and waste of everyday items.¹⁶

Stylebook - (\$1.4 Million USD)

Stylebook is a styling and wardrobe planning based app that caters to the needs of more fashionable people who are interested in looking their best. Stylebook focuses less on the sustainability aspects of fashion but still contributes to the repurposing of old clothes. Similar to Cladwell, Stylebook is technically based in the United States but it's accessible worldwide since it's an online platform. The app allows users to meticulously catalog their wardrobe, track how often they wear

¹⁶ <https://cladwell.com/>

certain outfits, and plan outfits in advance. Stylebook's target customer base are detail-oriented individuals who like to have things planned far in advance as well as people who just enjoy clothing and enjoy style. Most of Stylebook's features offer consumers the ability to remember the outfits they wore in the past with outfit cataloging and date tracking. It also provides users the opportunity to change up from their normal clothes and maybe try something on they haven't worn in a while. Overall, Stylebook is mostly for those more interested in fashion, efficiency, and the ability to experiment without ever trying on clothes.¹⁷

Pureple - (\$1.8 Million USD)

Pureple is an AI-Powered app that recommends outfits and style tips for the users, similar to the other two competitive apps but without the need for a subscription. With its headquarters based in the United States, Pureple is still available worldwide in the app store. Pureple helps create outfits for users based on pictures of their closet, wardrobes, and occasion needs. Pureple's primary customer base is budget-conscious users who want help planning and styling outfits without paying for a subscription service. The app uses a completely free model, allowing it to pull in a larger customer base but also forces them to use things like advertisements to monetize, which can scare away some users. Since it is a free application, Pureple has some downsides to it but still manages to target a large share of the consumer base in this industry and therefore remains a large competitor to look at.¹⁸ To see Cladwell, Stylebook, and Pureple in action please see Appendix 4.

¹⁷ <https://www.stylebookapp.com/>

¹⁸ <https://pureple.com/>

3.4 S.W.O.T. ANALYSIS

Cladwell – Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats Analysis

- **Strengths:**

- Price and Accessibility: Cladwell offers a user-friendly app with a free trial and subscription model, making it more accessible to a wider range of users.
- Sustainability Focus: Its emphasis on minimalism and capsule wardrobes appeals to eco-conscious consumers who want to reduce waste in fashion.
- User Experience: Cladwell provides personalized outfit recommendations based on user preferences, simplifying the decision-making process for consumers.

- **Weaknesses:**

- Limited Features for Fashion Enthusiasts: While Cladwell is great for minimalists, it might not appeal to fashion-forward users looking for more detailed styling tools or broader clothing variety.
- Subscription Model: While the app is affordable, its reliance on a subscription model could deter some users who are looking for fully free services.

- **Opportunities:**

- We can target the subscription-based model by providing an entirely free service that will appeal to any consumers uninterested in paying for the app and provide more features for different aspects of fashion

- **Threats:**

- Cladwell is currently the best app available that focuses on environmental sustainability in the fashion industry and it may be difficult to pull eco-conscious consumers away from their app.

Stylebook – Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats Analysis

- **Strengths:**

- Highly Detailed Wardrobe Organization: Stylebook's meticulous cataloging features appeal to users who want to track, plan, and organize their wardrobe in great detail.
- Outfit Planning: The app's ability to help users plan and track outfits in advance is a strong feature for fashion enthusiasts who enjoy managing their wardrobe actively.
- One-Time Purchase: Unlike subscription-based apps, Stylebook has a one-time purchase model, making it more attractive for users who want long-term value.

- **Weaknesses:**

- No AI-Powered Features: Stylebook does not offer AI-generated outfit recommendations, which could make it feel less innovative compared to competitors with advanced AI capabilities.
- Complexity for Casual Users: The app's highly detailed features could be overwhelming for casual users who prefer quick, intuitive solutions.

- **Opportunities:**

- Stylebook is more focused on attracting the stylish youth but it doesn't have any AI capabilities to assist with outfit planning or eco programs to help end fast fashion which makes it more of a style journal than a fashion assistant.

- **Threats:**

- Stylebook is the least threatening application as it has no AI assistant for outfit planning, and no environmental programs although it still may be difficult to pull some of the highly fashion conscious users.

Purple - Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats Analysis

- **Strengths:**

- AI-Powered Free Service: Purple offers AI-generated outfit suggestions, and the app is free, making it highly accessible to a broad audience of budget-conscious users.
- User-Friendly and Quick Setup: The app's simple interface and straightforward setup make it easy for users to upload their wardrobe and start receiving outfit suggestions without much hassle.
- Customization: Purple allows users to create and manage a virtual closet, customize outfits based on their own style, and receive recommendations suited to specific occasions.
- Global Availability: Purple's app is available worldwide, allowing it to reach a diverse user base across various regions without geographical limitations.

- **Weaknesses:**

- Basic Features for a Free App: Although the app is free, it lacks some of the more advanced features found in paid apps like Cladwell or Stylebook, such as detailed wardrobe tracking or premium design elements.
- Limited Appeal to Fashion Enthusiasts: Pureple's focus on simplicity and AI-generated outfits might not appeal to more fashion-forward users who desire more advanced styling tools or highly curated fashion advice.
- Monetization Strategy: Pureple's reliance on a free model may limit its ability to invest in new features, improvements, and customer support, potentially causing the app to lag behind paid competitors in terms of innovation and user satisfaction.

- **Opportunities:**

- Pureple is a strong player in this market as it has the largest customer base being a free app, however, because it is free, it is very simplistic and has many annoying advertisements with multiple consumers describing difficulty with the app.

- **Threats:**

- Pureple is free and so it might be hard to pull consumers to another free app if they don't see the benefit to switching. Pureple is admittedly very user-friendly and customizable, making it a vital competitor in the space.

3.5 MARKET SHARE ANALYSIS

Competitors' Market Share:

- Cladwell has a substantial presence in the sustainable fashion and capsule wardrobe market. Its appeal to eco-conscious users gives it a stable share in this niche part of the market.
- Stylebook also holds a significant portion of the market, especially more among fashion enthusiasts and users who enjoy meticulous wardrobe organization. Its one-time purchase model makes it attractive to long-term users.
- Pureple dominates the free AI-powered outfit recommendation market, holding a massive market share particularly among budget-conscious users looking for no-cost, easy-to-use solutions.

Overall, Vestium will be competing against established players that already have loyal user bases in different segments of the market—Cladwell in minimalism, Stylebook in organization, and Pureple in budget AI fashion solutions.

Prediction of Market Changes:

- As sustainability becomes an even bigger trend in fashion, Cladwell's market share could grow as more users gravitate towards capsule wardrobes.
- Stylebook may face stagnation unless it integrates AI capabilities to keep up with changing consumer preferences for more automated solutions.

- Pureple’s free model gives it an edge, but as the AI-powered fashion app landscape becomes more competitive, Pureple might need to add new features to retain users.

Vestium has the potential to carve out a unique space by combining personalized AI recommendations with a user-friendly wardrobe management system and a social media component, appealing to both style-conscious and tech-savvy users. If Vestium offers innovative features that stand out, it could quickly gain traction in the market.

3.6 ENTRY BARRIERS

Identifying Barriers:

- **Established Competitors:**
 - Cladwell, Stylebook, and Pureple all have established customer bases, brand recognition, and specific niches. They have already built trust and loyalty with users, which could make it difficult for Vestium to attract these customers away from their existing services.
- **Differentiation Challenge:**
 - Many apps already offer AI-driven outfit suggestions or wardrobe management tools. Vestium will need to clearly communicate its value proposition and show how it differentiates itself, whether through more advanced AI, superior user experience, or integration with fashion retailers.

- **Price Sensitivity:**

- With Pureple being a free app, Vestium will face significant price competition in the AI-driven fashion app market. Many users may opt for free options unless Vestium can demonstrate added value that justifies a premium price or subscription model.

- **Technological Development:**

- AI is becoming more common in fashion apps, and competitors may quickly adapt and innovate as well. This creates a need for Vestium to continually improve and stay ahead of the curve in terms of technology and user experience.

Strategies to Overcome Barriers:

- **Brand Differentiation:** Vestium can focus on offering a more comprehensive AI experience that combines daily outfit recommendations with advanced wardrobe management, style insights, and real-time analytics on fashion trends.
- **Price Positioning:** If Vestium is aiming for a premium service, it could offer a free version with basic features to attract users, while reserving its advanced AI capabilities, detailed wardrobe analytics, or personalized style consultations for paid users.
- **Partnerships with Fashion Retailers:** Integrating shopping features or collaborating with popular brands could enhance the app's appeal and distinguish it from competitors. Users could directly purchase AI-recommended outfits through the app, making it a more convenient solution than Pureple or Stylebook.

- **User Engagement and Retention:** Vestium can introduce features that keep users engaged, such as tracking style evolution, providing seasonal outfit suggestions, or offering challenges for creating outfits from their existing wardrobes. This would add value and foster long-term loyalty, especially against free alternatives.

With these strategies in place, Vestium can position itself as a competitive player in the growing AI-driven fashion app market, appealing to users looking for both convenience and style customization.

MARKETING PLAN

3.7 TARGET MARKET DEMOGRAPHICS/PSYCHOGRAPHICS

Our target market can be simplified into two distinct, yet relatable groups. The names of these two groups according to Esri Canada is "First Class Families" and "Downtown Verve". Vestium will first focus on the Downtown Verve. This demographic consists of younger and middle age upscale city dwellers. These higher net worth individuals enjoy discovering the city's art scene, dining out, and visiting entertainment districts. Furthermore, these individuals pursue a healthy lifestyle, and have progressive views towards environmentalism. These individuals are relatively well educated, and gravitate towards and work well with technology. The downtown verve category is associated with 1.19% of all Canadians, or approximately 445,488 individuals as of 2021. These individuals make a relatively large sum of money while working in white collar jobs in urban areas such as Montreal, Toronto and Calgary, with an average income of \$179, 524. These individuals enjoy going out in the

busy downtown scene, and often shop at retail stores such as Banana Republic. Furthermore, at home these individuals are often utilizing technology for both entertainment and work. Thus, these individuals who are already technologically savvy would mesh well with our product, and find ease in utilizing Vestium.

Our secondary target market is called, "First Class Families", with 737, 286 members or 1.53% of the population of Canada. First Class Families mainly consist of middle-aged parents with children aged 5-24. Furthermore, 90% of this demographic live in upscale, single-family homes. During time off, these families enjoy going out to shop, dine and relax. Furthermore, when they go out to shop, they often go to stores such as the Gap, Lululemon, SportCheck, and Roots. All stores that have a wide variety of clothing choices and are geared towards certain lifestyles. Members of the first class families demographic enjoy hobbies such as golf, boating as well as taking the children out to the amusement parks and sports. Dressing well and being put together is a seminal piece of participating in these hobbies.

Within both of these categories, Vestium will aim to target both males and females aged 15- 29, with middle to upper incomes. Vestium aims for both males and females to utilize our app, as both genders often seek help in deciding what to wear and would benefit from it. Furthermore, we are targeting the age range 15-29 as these individuals are people who are very comfortable with technology and would be willing to use our app on a daily basis for their daily requirements. In addition, this is an age range which cares about what they wear and how they dress. Thus, they would appreciate another voice suggesting what they should wear to impress others and look good, while maintaining confidence and competence in their dress. We would like to target both introverts as well as extroverts.

This is because extroverts will want to dress nicely to impress people or have their outfits be very nicely done up - and would enjoy utilizing our app for helping them achieve this goal. Introverts would also seek out our application as they may not be confident in what to wear, and may in fact be scared or shy. Our app would help solve this problem and instill confidence within these people as Vestium will develop a stylish outfit that suits their needs and desires, while allowing them to be comfortable and confident in front of others.

We want to target individuals who are conscientious with regards to what they spend money on and care about societal issues such as over consumption and ethical practices. This is because these kinds of people are likely to utilize our service as our service tackles issues such as over consumption and unethical practices. From using our service, the user will be able to maximize the clothes they already have - and formulate outfits they never even realized they had the potential to create with their current wardrobe. Our product differentiates itself from our competitors in various notable avenues. Firstly, Vestium leverages AI to both catalog your articles of clothing and create perfect outfits for you. Furthermore, we have a social media aspect to our platform, that allows individuals to showcase their outfits to the greater public - or just close friends. Finally, individuals are able to discover new fashions, styles and pieces of clothing that are relevant to them, and if the clothing brand has a deal with Vestium, users will be able to directly purchase articles of clothing through our application. To further see Vestium in use please see Appendix 5.

3.8 MARKET SIZE AND POTENTIAL

Vestium is entering a fast-growing AI market that will provide plenty of opportunities for our company. Vestium projects over 8 million potential Canadian consumers broken down into 400,000 from the Downtown Verve market segment, 700,00 from the First Class Families market segment, and over 7,000,000 people aged 15-29 living in Canada. As of right now there are over 200 million individuals that access AI-backed apps worldwide, and that number is rapidly growing. This gives Vestium an extraordinary opportunity to enter an industry that will allow us to scale worldwide. This industry isn't just big in consumer size but in monetary size as well. As of 2024, the industry size of AI in fashion is assessed at USD 3 Billion and is expected to reach USD 91 billion by the end of 2036. If Vestium takes even a sliver of market share, this extremely large industry will lead to immense profits, which is why we value the AI component of our application so highly. To take a deeper look into the Downtown Verve and First Class Families market segments please see Appendices 6 and 7.

3.9 GIS MARKET RESEARCH RESULTS

Although our consumers live coast to coast, Vestium has had to decide where to allocate its advertising budget to make it most effective. Our first generated map shows money spent on clothing in 2023 across Canada (see Appendix 8). As indicated by the deep red colour, consumers in Ontario spend the most on clothing annually, followed by Quebec, and then British Columbia. As such, it can be inferred that these consumers own plenty of clothes and therefore would want to make use of our app. A closer look at Ontario showcases that most of this spending is done in the Greater Toronto Area (see Appendix 9).

When looking at money spent on clothing within the GTA, the third map generated showcases hotspots where Vestium will focus its advertising (see Appendix 10). The majority of our early advertisements will be directed in these areas, as we want to make the most out of our limited start-up resources. Furthermore, our PRIZM Market Segment analysis (under Consumer Demographics) highlights Toronto as a city center full of consumers falling into the Downtown Verve or First Class families market segments, further adding to the value of placing advertisements there. Vestium will still incorporate advertisements coast to coast in major city centers such as Vancouver, as many of consumers from our targeted PRIZM Market Segments live in those major cities, but we will prioritize our advertising in the Greater Toronto Area.

3.10 MARKET TRENDS AND GROWTH PATTERNS

The AI market is relatively new, with artificial intelligence technology making significant strides in the past five years. In 2020, the AI market was worth USD 93 billion and has grown to USD 184 billion in 2024, doubling in value over just four years.¹⁹ This immense growth has been due to the significant strides made in AI technology. As artificial intelligence has become smarter, its use has become more widespread, allowing its market to grow. Furthermore, the market is projected to explode, with a projected value of USD 827 billion by 2030. This projection is due to the societal trends taking place. Artificial intelligence is used by hundreds of millions across the world on a daily basis. As more consumers begin to adopt the use of AI in their daily lives, the market will continue to grow. Economists project that humanity will become much more open to the use of AI in the next five

¹⁹ <https://www.statista.com/forecasts/1474143/global-ai-market-size#:~:text=The%20market%20for%20artificial%20intelligence,billion%20U.S.%20dollars%20in%202030.>

years, which is why the industry is projected to grow so rapidly. Currently, 55% of North American consumers regularly use AI, a number that has grown from less than 5% five years ago.²⁰ In the next five years, it is projected that over 90% of North Americans will regularly use AI, proving the market's value to Vestium. It is important to note that there are hundreds of thousands of applications that are making use of AI, with that number expected to rapidly grow over the next five years. However, Vestium's app brings features to consumers that our competitors won't be able to match, so we are confident we will gain a strong market share. Additionally, there are no strong seasonal trends in this industry as people get dressed daily and will need Vestium's assistance in choosing an outfit daily. As such, Vestium does not have to worry about spikes and dips in the use of our app throughout the year.

3.11 PRICING STRATEGY AND POSITIONING

We plan to charge nothing to consumers as all of our profits will come from advertisement and commission money which is a massive advantage over our subscription-based competitors. At Vestium, we realize that most consumers don't want to spend money on more online subscriptions and recurring payments, so we made the platform completely free to use. Also, because our product is an app and more of a service than a product, there will be basically no variable costs for production. The fixed costs however will include the following: App Development, App Maintenance, Experiential Marketing, Online marketing, HQ Rent, Computers x4, Data storage, Servers, App developer salary, Water, Electricity, Internet, Licenses and Permits, Legal, Business Registration, Insurance, Sponsorships, Consumer Research, and Salaries. Our margins in year one will be slim

²⁰ <https://www.nyu.edu/blog/ai-statistics-trends/#:~:text=A%20survey%20by%20Pew%20Research,do%20not%20regularly%20use%20AI>.

however, our profits will outweigh our expenditures by \$150,000 by at least year 3. We will also be using penetration pricing to help maximize our customers and users on our app. To view the expenditures chart showcasing Vestium's projected finances please see Appendix 11.

3.12 BRANDING

The name of our company is Vestium. Vestium translated from Latin to English means "fashion". We decided to go ahead with this name as our company is intertwined with fashion as consumers are utilizing our application to create better fashion practices for themselves. Furthermore, the word "Vestium" is catchy, exudes a sense of luxury and is appealing to our target demographics and is memorable and outstanding. Our logo is the letter "V" to reflect the name of our company, "Vestium". However, its font delivers a sense of elegance and tastefulness, yet remaining simplistic and tender to the eye. The color is gold, which seems to glimmer while resting upon a light-dark purple gradient as this further delivers the sense of prosperity.

Our slogan is "snap into style". This slogan offers a double meaning. Firstly, it speaks to how users can take a picture of articles of clothing, and the application will assemble styles and outfits for them. Secondly, it speaks to how individuals will immediately be graced with amazing outfits and look stylish. The font and color are similar to the rest of the words in the logo to give the overall logo a complete and uniform look - all delivering the same message of being proper and put together. The entire logo is overlaid on a purple gradient background, which resembles an article of textile. Purple is commonly associated with confidence, prosperity and elegance, and we want our users to feel this way when they use our application to put on amazing outfits. The image Vestium seeks to put forth is one

that is reliable, stylish and pleasing to the eye, and one of making people feel confident in what they wear. To view Vestium's logo and slogan please see Appendix 12.

Vestium will utilize problem and benefit positioning, as we will address a variety of problems on different levels. We will address problems people have day to day such as being insecure about what one wears in public, to major social topics and issues such as over consumption. We will offer to conquer these problems with the usage of our AI fueled fashion app, as our app will be able to aid in fixing many of these topics and issues. Furthermore, we will have service positioning, as we offer a unique service that combines AI into the world of fashion.

3.13 ADVERTISING AND SALES PROMOTIONS

In order to get the message about Vestium out, we will pursue a multitude of advertising and marketing methods.

Firstly, we will perform marketing maneuvers on apps through paying apps to display our ads. This maybe done through 10-30 second unskippable ads, which have the user waiting for the ad to finish before they can resume their game or utilizing the app. We will showcase how our app works through a quick demonstration video illustrating the power of Vestium and the wonders it can work to unlock one's wardrobe potential. This method of marketing is beneficial as the people who will use our app are likely already technology oriented, and thus are often on their phones and devices - however are using other applications. We will focus our ads on our target market who are in the age range of 15-29 years of age.

We know that this strategy will be effective because according to publifit.com: "Research on in-app advertising statistics reveals that in-app ads have a click through rate (CTR) of 0.56% compared to 0.23% for mobile web ads. In-app ads also have a customer conversion rate that is three times higher than traditional ads and a user retention rate that is four times that of traditional ads."²¹ For an example of an in-app advertisement please see Appendix 13. Publifit isn't alone on this approach to in app advertisements, as a plethora other reputable sites share this viewpoint. The approximate cost per mile for this initiative is \$5, meaning that for every 1000 impressions, it costs roughly \$5. Thus, taking into account we are aiming for about 1.4 million impressions per year that will mainly target our primary and secondary consumers, the overall cost per year will be \$7000. However, we will allocate a total of \$30,000 towards in app and online marketing each year for the first 4 years of operations in order to entice as many users as possible and grow our consumer base.

Since these advertisements will be targeting major technology users, likely towards the ages of 15-29 we will make our in app advertisements appealing to them. Our Unique Selling Proposition for these in app advertisements will primarily showcase how our app leverages AI and technology to generate impeccable outfits. In this particular in app advertising example, the big idea illustrates a young woman using her app to craft herself an outfit based off of what she has in her wardrobe. The lady is unsure of what she wants to wear, and thus pulls out her phone and opens the Vestium app. With this, she scans a few items from her wardrobe, and immediately the app generates outfits for her. The next scene shows her coming out of the closet with a stunning outfit on, along with the Vestium

²¹ <https://www.publifit.com/blog/in-app-advertising-for-publishers#:~:text=Research%20on%20in%2Dapp%20advertising,times%20that%20of%20traditional%20ads>

app open in her hand. She then states, "Snap into style with Vestium!". Along with this, the words pop up onto the screen in a catchy font that will entice our demographic, with a "click here" button to incentivize viewers to download the app immediately. Once this happens, the app store on their phones will open onto the Vestium app, and potential users will be prompted to download the app. Once they download the app, it will automatically be logged that they downloaded the app from an in-app advertisement, that way we can track their activity and see if in-app advertisements are able to derive long term users of Vestium successfully.

In addition to in-app ads, we will also conduct in person, experiential marketing exhibits. In person experiential marketing is an extremely effective method, with a high turnover rate as users are able to interact with the product/service and experience it firsthand. According to Persuasion Nation as of 2024, "experiential marketing has a success rate of 38.34%, making it one of the most effective marketing strategies".²² Furthermore, our target age demographic of extroverted 15-29 year olds enjoy being hands on and experiencing things in order to learn about them. Thus, Vestium would like to leverage experiential marketing so that potential users can utilize the application and it's features firsthand. For this, we will have booths available in malls where our target markets - the downtown verve and fist class families- frequent. To see a mockup of Vestium's experiential marketing exhibit please see Appendix 14. This includes major suburban malls such as the Eaton Centre in Toronto, The Eaton Centre Montreal, The CORE in Calgary and the CF Pacific Centre. In addition, these places receive very high volumes of people and this will allow our booth to intercept as many people as

²² <https://persuasion-nation.com/experiential-marketing-statistics/>

possible. However, in the earlier stages, we will primarily focus on the Eaton Centre in Toronto as our primary testing site as this is close to our Headquarters and will be easier for our startup to access.

How this promotional event will work is that we will have a booth with all sorts of clothing spanning a plethora of styles allowing any individual who comes along to be able to have an experience that caters towards their taste in clothes and caters to them in a more realistic day to day sense. Furthermore, we will have phones available with the app, however we will have staff present to encourage users to download the app then and there and create their accounts so that they can start using the application on their own device.

Ideally, consumers download the app at the booths, as this already causes them to follow through one of the most challenging aspects of this startup for us - which is getting people to download the app. Once the app is downloaded, they will then be asked how they found out about the app, and users will select "Vestium Booth". This will allow us to track their future activities and monitor the effectiveness of these experiential marketing booths and their abilities to retain users. Once they have followed the on screen instructions, they can begin to use the app and try it on the articles of clothing we have presented there. Once they use the AI algorithm and witness it working first hand, they will likely be enticed to use it during the rest of their shopping excursion to see what outfits they can compile. And once they arrive back home, they are likely to test it again on their personal clothes and use it - where Vestium is confident that they will continue to use it on a daily basis.

The approximate cost of a two week long campaign is \$10,000, as Cadillac Fairview, the parent company of the Eaton Centre charges approximately \$3000-\$7000 per month for small kiosks and

booths, and we will still have to pay for the setup costs and creation of the booths.²³ Although our campaign will only run for about 2 weeks, we will still need to pay employees who will maintain and run the experiential marketing booth. However, we will offset these costs by gaining many new users on our application, who will generate revenue as they utilize Vestium and come across advertisements from other places, shop on our app, and use our built-in social media capabilities.

3.14 PUBLIC RELATIONS

Through our massive breakthrough and innovative approach to the fashion and technology space, Vestium is bound to spur excitement and entice reputable writers to craft articles pertaining to the startup. Ideally, we would like to get on board with relevant sources such as GQ. GQ is a flagship publication site that focuses on trends and especially fashion. Furthermore, this site is frequented by many people aged 15-29 in urban areas, our key age demographic, who look to see the latest trends in the market. Thus, Vestium seeks to get free publicity by getting articles and videos created about our innovative app, that will be primarily directed at our key demographic.

Another site that may feature us due to the nature of our business is Business Insider. This site covers a breadth of topics that have a connection to business. They highlight business and trend setters around the world, and the impact they are making on the world. They especially like to highlight breakthroughs in the lifestyle, trend and technology spaces, which is perfect for Vestium as it has roots in many of these categories. On top of that, many business executives and professionals read this site. An article about Vestium may roll onto the desk of one of these executives, and it is possible that we

²³ <https://forums.redflagdeals.com/leasing-space-eaton-centre-yorkdale-square-one-mall-466993/>

could develop a new key connection that way which could help us create brand extensions, secure more funding, or aid our company in a multitude of other ways.

While GQ focuses on the male demographic primarily, we will also aim to issue a press release with Vogue - which will be geared towards the female demographic. Vogue is a well-regarded site that covers the latest trends in fashion and business and has recently dove into the world of digital fashion and fashion technologies.

Incredible sites such as GQ, Vogue and business insider could talk about a number of things about Vestium. However, we believe that if they spoke to our in-person experiences at downtown malls such as the Eaton Centre, this would be of great benefit to us. This is because it would help spread the word about our experiential marketing campaign and possibly drive more people to come, visit us, and utilize the app firsthand which will result in more users on our application. To see an example of a Vestium Press Release please see Appendix 15.

3.15 MARKET RESEARCH

Our main market research strategy will be primary research through surveys that will be conducted on TikTok and Instagram. These surveys will be short questionnaires asking questions such as how much respondents spend on clothes every month, how much they trust artificial intelligence, or how much they use social media. The conclusions we will draw from the surveys will help us gain a broader understanding of our consumer base and whether there are specific hotspots containing more potential users. The secondary market research we used was largely websites such as Statistics Canada and other related census and industry statistics along with ArcGIS that allowed us to find high density

population areas of different consumer groups that we can target.²⁴ Primary and secondary sources play different but important roles in collecting information with primary giving more in depth results, and secondary sources having the ability to take a broader view of a market and consumer base.

SALES STRATEGY – ‘GO TO MARKET’ STRATEGY

3.16 SALES PROCESS AND INCENTIVES

In order to attract businesses to advertise on Vestium, we will illustrate our strong user base and just how many people use and spend time with our applications. This will be done through showing our consumer statistics and demographics. Furthermore, we will show how much time users spend on our application and the high amount of interaction users have with it. Then, we will identify and offer ad space found in various places on our apps. This includes interstitial ads which will be placed at natural transition spaces within our application. We may also do banner ads, which are "fixed" within the app, and do not take away from the user experience at all. Furthermore, we will use native ads, which are ads that are heavily integrated into our application that do not take away from the user experience. Essentially, all of our spaces are spaces that will draw attention and get consumers to regard them, however they will not interfere with the user experience and users will still be able to enjoy the application.

To accomplish these tasks, we will utilize Google AdMob, which is a resource created by Google which connects apps with companies and brands wanting advertisement space on their apps. Google AdMob is free to use and will allow Vestium to display only appropriate and relevant

²⁴ <https://www.statcan.gc.ca/en/start>

advertisements from other companies on our app. Google AdMob works around the globe, which is excellent as this will allow us to generate revenue from companies willing to pay for advertisements from all over the globe since we will have clients from all over the world. Furthermore, Google AdMob will help us especially during the initial stages of our revenue strategy - however as more companies start advertising on our page, word may spread and we may organically be able to lock in larger deals with companies.

Another source of revenue will come through commissions from articles of clothing purchased through our app in the marketplace section. In this area of our app, users will be able to see pieces of clothing that will be recommended for their wardrobe. If a company wishes to push their product on our app, they will have to pay a 10% commission fee on the retail price of that product. This will allow them to have their product recommended closer to the top of the page, and be more apparent to the app user. Furthermore, for all other regular sales of any clothing on our app, Vestium will benefit from a 5% commission. However, we will encourage companies to push their product on our app by granting us the 10% commission fee by highlighting the incredible amount of traffic and day to day interaction our application achieves from our target demographics.

3.17 DISTRIBUTION AND PLACE

We will get users to download our app on the Apple App store and the Google Play Store. For us, this method will be free besides the research and development of the app, and the \$99 per year fee. Furthermore, when consumers buy clothing off of our app, the stores and the brands selling the clothing on our platform will be the ones handling the distribution processes. From this, we will

actually generate revenue through the commission we will receive off of third party sales to our app users.

4.0 RESOURCE ANALYSIS

HUMAN RESOURCES

4.1 DESCRIPTION OF MANAGEMENT TEAM

Ethan Fleming - CEO

- Maintains and creates future vision
- Establishes decisions
- Public appearances, ex. talks with the press
- Oversees Vestium's operations
- Is accountable for the wellbeing of the company
- Holds other individuals accountable
- Please see Appendix 16 for Mr. Fleming's resume

Miraj Siddiqui - COO

- Ensures operational efficiency
- Controls management and ensures departments are in working order
- Enacts the strategic vision set by CEO
- Addresses operational challenges and pivots for fixes
- In charge of leading marketing initiatives and rollout

- Please see Appendix 17 for Mr. Siddiqui's resume

Liam Milenov - CFO

- Ensures the financial survival of our company
- Monitors cash flow
- Seeks ways of maintaining status quo while reducing costs
- Manages portfolio of shareholders
- Establishes salaries for key Vestium employees
- Please see Appendix 18 for Mr. Milenov's resume

John Qing - CTO

- Ensures the smooth operation on the technology side of the app
- Addresses fixes and finds improvements
- In charge of finding beneficial employees for the creation of the app
- Please see Appendix 19 for Mr. Qing's resume

4.2 DIRECTORS

At this stage of Vestium, we are not yet able to facilitate a board of directors. However, in the future of Vestium, as we continue to experience growth, we may create a board of directors to help dictate the future success and vision of the company.

4.3 SHAREHOLDERS AND INVESTORS

Partner Investors:

Miraj Siddiqui (COO): 30% (valued at \$600,000)

Ethan Fleming (CEO): 30% (valued at \$600,000)

Liam Milenov (CFO): 30% (valued at \$600,000)

Outside Investors:

Deana Harris: 5% (valued at \$100,000)

Matt Jaekal: 5% (valued at \$100,000)

Please see Appendix 20 for a visual breakdown of shareholders.

4.4 PROFESSIONAL ADVISORS AND CONSULTANTS

Lawyer - Jason Allan, Allan Law

Phone: (905) 726-3188

Address: 16 Industrial Parkway South, Unit #111 Aurora, Ontario L4G 0R4

Based out of the Aurora/Newmarket area, Jason Allan brings his respectable background and insights of the law world to Vestium. Boasting a law degree from the University of Western Ontario, after joining the Bar, Jason gained immense experience while practicing law for prominent law firms in the Toronto downtown core. Jason joined the firm of his father in 2010, and eventually took over the firm with the retirement of his father in 2018 and has since delivered success to his firm along with his clients. Vestium witnesses the value within Jason Allan and his law firm, and currently utilizes his

services for the start up portion of Vestium - which includes gaining permits, licenses and establishing contracts.

Compensation: \$250 per hour of service

Banker - Reza Aghdasi

Phone: (905) 727-4123

Address: 14845 Yonge Street, Aurora, ON L4G 6H8

With over 10 years of banking and financial advisory experience for small businesses, Reza Aghdasi of TD bank allows Vestium access to funds and financial resources for the establishment of our business. Our CFO Liam Milenov will be in direct and constant contact with Reza in order to ensure that the financial requirements for the longevity of Vestium are being fulfilled.

Compensation: \$75 per hour of service

Drake McCleave, CPA - Accountant

Phone: (289) 221-8407

Email: dmccleave@mcclleavecpa.com

Drake McCleave is the owner of the public accounting firm located in Aurora, Ontario known as McCleave Chartered Professional Accountants. Drake specializes in aiding small businesses with their accounting through his extensive experience and knowledge of the realm of accounting. Our CFO Liam Milenov will remain close to Drake and his team at McCleave Chartered Professional Accountants to ensure the accounting and numbers side of operations at Vestium remain afloat.

Compensation: \$200 per hour of service

Eddie Donan - Real Estate Agent

Phone: (647) 449-4520

Email: info@eddiedonanteam.ca.

Address: 15004 Yonge St, Aurora, ON L4G 1M6

Eddie Donan is a full time real estate agent servicing the Greater Toronto Area (including Aurora) for the needs of both residential and commercial real estate seekers. Throughout his successful career, Eddie has won numerous awards and accolades, which speak to his ability to find impeccable and strategic locations for his clients - such as Vestium.

Compensation: 5% commission

4.5 COMPENSATION

At this point in time, each of our C-level employees of Vestium will receive annual compensation of \$50,000 CAD. This includes the personnel of Miraj Siddiqui (COO), Ethan Fleming (CEO), and Liam Milenov (CFO).

MATERIAL RESOURCES

4.6 LOCATION

The planned location of our business will be a small office building located in Aurora Ontario which is right in the heart of the biggest cluster of our target market in the GTA. However, our building will largely be used for the storage of our data servers meaning outside of a few meetings, the

business itself is not impacted by our location. Additionally, our location is near where all Vestium employees live, has little traffic, and is surrounded by urban infrastructure, making it a great area to have our office in.

4.7 FACILITIES AND EQUIPMENT

Vestium will be leasing an office within an office building located in Aurora, Ontario at Unit 4, 117 Wellington Street East. This lease will cost Vestium \$850 a month, and will accommodate all employees required to launch our business. The office, which is 1000 square feet, will provide Vestium with offices for each of its employees, meeting space with potential partners or investors, and storage space for Vestiums servers. The lease will begin in January 2025, allowing Vestium to move in and start business quickly. As Vestium is an app, we will not require much equipment within the office other than the technology mentioned below under Technological Resources. Furthermore, the office comes fully furnished minimizing startup costs of furniture for our company. Please see Appendix 21 for photos of the exterior, interior, and layout of the office.

4.8 TECHNOLOGICAL RESOURCES

Vestium will require 10 servers to launch its app and run the day-to-day operations within the business. These servers will host the online traffic on the Vestium application, allowing our app to run smoothly, providing the best possible experience to our consumers. Vestium will also require computers for its employees within the office. These computers will be used to run our business and are vital to ensuring Vestium runs on a day-to-day basis. To handle updates to Vestium's app software, server maintenance, and computer troubleshooting, Vestium will hire a Chief Technology Officer,

John Qing, who has an extensive background in computer hardware, software, and the entire technological sector. Mr. Qing's experience will be leveraged to update the Vestium app and maintain Vestium's technological infrastructure, making him invaluable to the company.

5.0 OPERATING STRATEGY

HUMAN RESOURCES MANAGEMENT

5.1 STAFFING AND TRAINING

As Vestium is a startup we will require little staff other than our three founders. As such, the only employee Vestium will hire, will be our Chief Technology Officer (CTO), John Qing. Mr. Qing will be hired full-time, and under his umbrella will be responsible for coding and updating Vestiums app, maintaining our servers, and ensuring the Vestium network remains operational for our employees to access and utilize. Mr. Qing has an extensive background in computer science and computer engineering and will be continuing his education with a computer engineering degree at university next fall. As a result, Mr. Qing will require no training from Vestium, as he has prior experience in the field. The company is looking forward to bringing Mr. Qing and his valuable knowledge and experience on board. Additionally, it is important to note that Vestium will be contracting Mr. Jason Allan as our lawyer, Mr. Reza Aghdasi as our banker, Mr. Drake McCleave as our accountant, and Mr. Eddie Donan as our real estate agent. These four consultants will be contracted by Vestium and will not be official employees, meaning they will not require any training from our company.

5.2 LABOUR CONSIDERATIONS

As Vestium is just a startup with limited capital, Mr. Qing will be paid \$30,000 in his first year. However, as Vestium continues to grow, Mr. Qing will be well compensated for his significant contributions to our company. Furthermore, Vestium will offer Mr. Qing, as well as Mr. Fleming, Mr. Siddiqui, and Mr. Milenov, health insurance, unemployment insurance contributions, and vacation pay, to ensure working at Vestium is a positive experience. As our lawyer, banker, accountant, and real estate agent are contracted and not employees, they will not be given employee benefits and will be paid depending on the services they provide and hours they work, so their pay will be condition based and cannot be accurately predicted at this time.

5.3 MANAGEMENT CONTROL/ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

Each full-time owner or employee - Mr. Fleming, Mr. Siddiqui, Mr. Milenov, and Mr. Qing - will work Monday to Friday from 9:00 A.M. to 5:00 P.M. These working hours are both fair to ourselves and our employee and will give each of us enough time to put the hard work into the company that is needed for it to succeed. Additionally, Vestium's organizational structure chart has been included in Appendix 22, showcasing the levels of control each member of the Vestium organization has.

MANUFACTURING AND MATERIAL RESOURCES MANAGEMENT

5.4 MANUFACTURING PLANS AND COSTS

As Vestium is providing a service through our app, there will be no manufacturing costs for us to consider. We have no raw materials, no labour towards creating a product, and no overhead costs

for finished goods. The cost to create our app has been worked into the salary of our CTO, Mr. John Qing (app developer salary), so will not be considered as a manufacturing cost. As such, manufacturing plans and costs is not a worry or consideration for our company.

5.5 SUPPLIERS

Vestium's business takes place online and it does not have any physical products for sale. As such we have no suppliers or subcontractors to consider. However, as part of Vestium is an online clothing marketplace, the companies selling clothes on our app can be seen as suppliers. While these suppliers operate under Vestiums online domain, they are each their own entity and as such will be responsible for their own suppliers and subcontractors who help them to produce the clothes that they sell. The Vestium app acts as a bridge between consumers and these companies, so Vestium will also not have any inventory to consider, because each company utilizing our online domain to make sales will be responsible for managing and ordering their own inventories.

5.6 QUALITY CONTROL

Vestium takes pride in its customer service and the smoothness of our app. As such we will take a variety of quality control measures to ensure our product has minimal service problems. Firstly, the Vestium app will undergo comprehensive testing. We will test its function, performance under a high volume of users, its useability, security, and compatibility with different types of devices to help detect and solve potential problems before they reach the consumer. Additionally, we will continuously develop and update the app, fixing bugs and other issues with in to ensure it runs smoothly for consumers. Thirdly, we will incorporate real-time monitoring, analytics, and user

feedback functions into the app, so problems are quickly found and in turn can be quickly solved.

Finally, users will be taken through a training session on how to use the app when they download it, to reduce consumer confusion and frustration, minimizing service issues. The app will also incorporate clear and helpful error messages if a problem does occur and will be able to automatically recover to quickly restore service if a failure takes place. All in all, Vestium has incorporated a wide variety of quality control measures to ensure that our consumers have the best possible experience while using our app, something extremely important for the Vestium company to provide its loyal users.

5.7 ENVIRONMENTAL AND OTHER ISSUES

Vestium's product is completely online with the only tangible goods - being the clothes sold through our app - coming from the clothing companies utilizing our app to sell their product. As such zoning requirements do not apply to our company as the office we are utilizing is already built and is being rented. Furthermore, Vestium does not have any environmental approvals or health and safety requirements to consider, except for ensuring our office space is clean and up to code. However, Vestium will require trademarks on our logo, name, and slogan. Furthermore, we will patent our application so it cannot be recreated and will place a copyright on this report and other written work that we produce. Additionally, we will need to register our business, obtain a sales tax permit, and apply for a business license. We will undergo this long legal process with the assistance of our lawyer, Mr. Jason Allans, so it is not a worry for our company. Finally, our business will operate in an environmentally aware and socially responsible manner as highlighted under the Social Impact section

of this report. As a company Vestium is committed to bettering the environment and in turn the world that we all call home.

6.0 FINANCIAL STRATEGY

6.1 FINANCIAL SUMMARY AND FUNDING REQUESTED

Our company will be seeking \$200,000 in equity financing from a private investor along with a \$100,000 bank loan and \$100,000 of our own money to help fund the startup. The equity financing will be 10% of our company in exchange for \$200,000, valuing our company at 2 million dollars. This money will be used to fund the expenses seen under Appendix 23.

These costs include startup or “one time” payments along with recurring yearly expenses. Our team has already invested \$100,000 and qualified for a matching \$100,000 small business loan through TD Bank and a \$25,000 small business technology grant. This loan has no interest charged to us as we take advantage of the Canadian small businesses program as well. The most difficult part of this section of the report was to evaluate our entire business as a whole, but after careful consideration, we arrived at a 2 million dollars valuation. This was in part because of the business idea and the unique market segment we know we can take advantage of, but also because of our financial projections and the fact we will earn a projected 4.5 million dollars over our first 10 years of our business. Overall, we will receive \$200,000 dollars from investors, \$200,000 from a loan and our personal financing, and a \$25,000 dollar grant.

FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS

6.2 PROJECTED CASH FLOW STATEMENTS

Below is Vestium's Projected Cash Flow Statement, which indicates the amount and timings of our expected cash inflows and outflows. This is one of the most important parts of launching our venture, and as such a great deal of thought has been put into it by our management team.

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5	Total
Cash In						
Estimated online revenue	\$ 393,250.00	\$ 452,237.50	\$ 520,073.13	\$ 598,084.09	\$ 687,796.71	\$ 2,651,441.43
Cash Out						
Salaries	\$ 150,000.00	\$ 165,000.00	\$ 181,500.00	\$ 199,650.00	\$ 219,615.00	\$ 915,765.00
App developer salary	\$ 86,736.00					\$ 86,736.00
App Development	\$ 50,000.00					\$ 50,000.00
Online marketing	\$ 30,000.00	\$ 30,000.00	\$ 30,000.00	\$ 30,000.00	\$ 30,000.00	\$ 150,000.00
Legal	\$ 24,000.00	\$ 24,000.00	\$ 24,000.00	\$ 24,000.00	\$ 24,000.00	\$ 120,000.00
Loan Payback	\$ 20,000.00	\$ 20,000.00	\$ 20,000.00	\$ 20,000.00	\$ 20,000.00	\$ 100,000.00
HQ Rent	\$ 10,200.00	\$ 10,200.00	\$ 10,200.00	\$ 10,200.00	\$ 10,200.00	\$ 51,000.00
Experiential Marketing	\$ 10,000.00	\$ 5,000.00	\$ 3,000.00			\$ 18,000.00
Data storage	\$ 10,000.00	\$ 12,000.00	\$ 14,000.00	\$ 16,000.00	\$ 18,000.00	\$ 70,000.00
Consumer Research	\$ 10,000.00	\$ 5,000.00				\$ 15,000.00
App Maintenance	\$ 7,500.00	\$ 7,500.00	\$ 10,000.00	\$ 10,000.00	\$ 12,500.00	\$ 47,500.00
Servers	\$ 5,000.00	\$ 7,500.00	\$ 10,000.00	\$ 12,500.00	\$ 15,000.00	\$ 50,000.00
Computers x4	\$ 4,000.00					\$ 4,000.00
Internet	\$ 2,400.00	\$ 2,400.00	\$ 2,400.00	\$ 2,400.00	\$ 2,400.00	\$ 12,000.00
Insurance	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 1,000.00	\$ 5,000.00
Business registration	\$ 360.00					\$ 360.00
App Store Fee	\$ 99.00	\$ 99.00	\$ 99.00	\$ 99.00	\$ 99.00	\$ 495.00
Total Costs	\$421,295.00	\$289,699.00	\$306,199.00	\$325,849.00	\$352,814.00	\$1,695,856.00
Net Cash						
Yearly Surplus		\$ 162,538.50	\$ 213,874.13	\$ 272,235.09	\$ 334,982.71	\$ 983,630.43
Yearly Deficit	-\$28,045.00					-\$28,045.00
Cumulative	-\$28,045.00	\$ 134,493.50	\$ 348,367.63	\$ 620,602.72	\$ 955,585.43	\$ 2,031,004.27

Figure 2 – Vestium's Projected Cash Flow Statement

6.3 PROJECTED INCOME STATEMENT

Due to the nature of Vestium's business, our projected income statements have been grouped together with our projected cash flow statements above. As such, Vestium has been advised not to include a projected income statement within this report.

6.4 FINANCIAL ASSUMPTIONS

Revenue:

Vestium expects a growth rate of 176 % per year on average for the first 5 years, as indicated by market research and calculations performed by our external accountant, financial advisor/banker and our CFO Liam Milenov. Based off of the commission and advertising viewership deals we will make, Vestium's expected revenue over the course of the first 5 years is \$2,031,004.27.

App Developer Salary:

The app developer salary was calculated based off of the current salary market for app developers. According to talent.com, a leading source of statistics for the pay of certain occupations and positions, the average app developer for a startup company earns around \$84,123.²⁵ However, at Vestium we seek to attract the best employees and app developers while maintaining our budget. Thus, our company decided to upgrade the offered pay to \$86,736 in order to attract more experienced app developers who will develop an outstanding application.

App Development:

²⁵ <https://ca.talent.com/salary?job=app+developer>

This cost accounts for creating the app aside from the app developer salary. This includes obtaining licenses and registration, building and launching the app on app stores, and obtaining the other necessary technological requirements for the creation of the app. This figure was derived from the cost to create other similar apps - however we considered that our app will have more features and be above these other apps, thus the cost of building our app is slightly higher in comparison to the cost of other apps.²⁶

Online Marketing:

Vestium has decided upon a total online advertising budget of \$30,000 per year. This will allow Vestium to reach its target demographic and expand and grow our company. As previously mentioned in our advertising and marketing plan, this figure was determined by analyzing the CPM for in-app and online marketing ads, then adjusting it for the amount of impressions we seek to make. Furthermore, we allot more funds towards this initiative as we see it as a key factor for gathering and growing a strong consumer base of primary, secondary, and other consumers.

Legal:

Our lawyer charges \$250 per hour. Thus, assuming an average usage of 96 hours per year, the total is $\$250 \times 96$ which is equal to our total per year.

Loan Payback:

Based off of a Canadian Federal Government Business Loan free of interest.

²⁶ <https://www.businessofapps.com/app-developers/research/app-development-cost/>

HQ Rent:

Established based on the renting fee stated previously.

Experiential Marketing:

As indicated in the advertising and marketing section of the Vestium business plan report, the cost of this booth at the Eaton Centre will be \$10,000 for the first year. However, as we continue to grow, in the first few years, we will do more or less experiential marketing as we see fit and depending on its effectiveness. In our financial statements, we have indicated that the cost will go down as we progress. This is because we expect that we will not need to run the booth after year 3 and that since we will have the necessary components from the year prior, the cost per year to run the booth will go down.

Data Storage:

This cost was calculated based on the amount of data we would be storing per year. This research was conducted by our CTO and this number is extremely specific to Vestium and our required storage capacity.

Consumer Research:

Calculated based upon required resources in order to track and observe the behaviors of our target demographics. It is important to note that there are currently fiscal spending projections for consumer research in years 1 and 2. This is because by year 3, Vestium seeks to have a firm grasp on its target market. Furthermore, we hope that we will be able to grow to a point where we can have in-house employees in charge of observing our target demographics, and thus we would not have to be

outsourced. At that point, the consumer research budget would then be allocated to the employee salary budget instead.

App Maintenance:

Calculated based off of the average amount it costs for general maintenance for an app on a yearly basis.

Servers:

Calculated based on industry averages.²⁷

Computers:

Calculated with assumption that each computer for our office space will cost \$1000 each after negotiations and discounts are included.

Internet:

Calculated based off of cost posted on Bell Canada's website.

Insurance:

Calculated based off of estimates given by Vestium's Financial Advisor.

Business Registration:

Fee noted from Lawyer and Financial Advisor.

²⁷ <https://thexoteam.com/how-much-does-a-server-cost/#:~:text=Buying%20a%20server%20for%20your%20business%20can%20rack%20you%20up,processor%2C%20motherboard%20and%20power%20supply.>

App Store Fee:

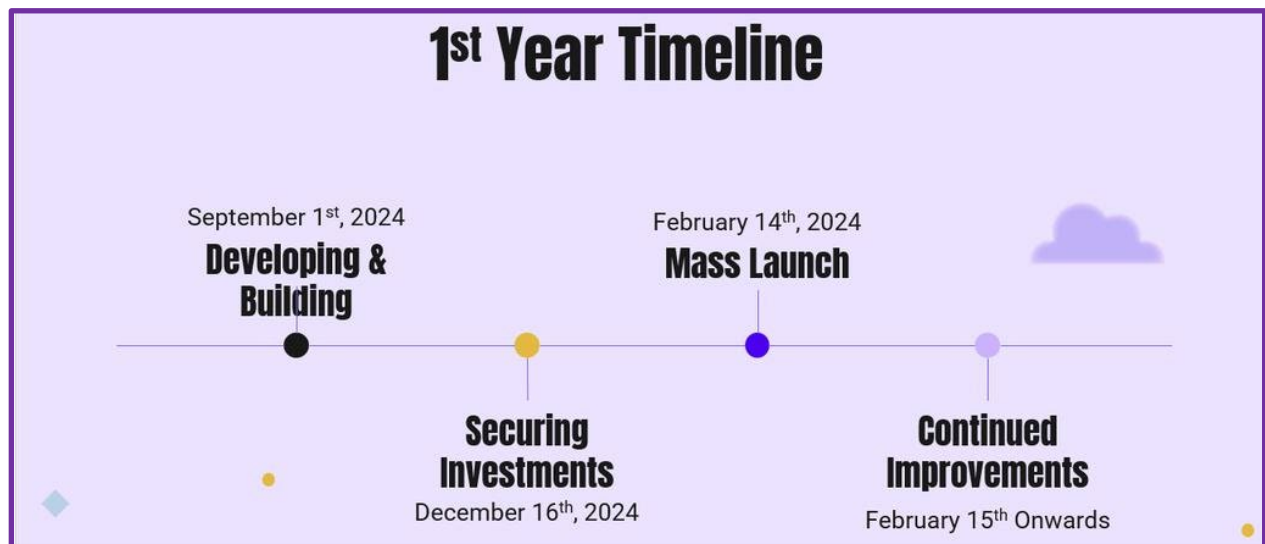
Found directly from Apple Canada, the Apple App Store, the Samsung App Store, and the Google Play App Store.

6.5 BREAK EVEN ANALYSIS

The way our business functions with our revenue coming in a manner that's different from simply buying and selling, it's practically impossible to determine an exact breakeven point for a number of units sold. To counteract this, we simply calculated our projected net profit per month, and in which we found that by March of year two, we will break even. Please see our break even analysis under Appendix 24.

7.0 APPENDICIES

Appendix 1 – First Year Timeline



Appendix 2 – Contractor Contact Information and Profiles

Lawyer - Jason Allan, Allan Law

Phone: (905) 726-3188

Address: 16 Industrial Parkway South, Unit #111 Aurora, Ontario

L4G 0R4



Banker - Reza Aghdasi

Address: 14845 Yonge Street, Aurora, ON L4G 6H8

Phone: (905) 727-4123



Drake McCleave, CPA - Accountant

Phone: (289) 221-8407

Email: dmcleave@mccleavecpa.com



Eddie Donan - Real Estate Agent

Address: 15004 Yonge St, Aurora, ON L4G 1M6

Phone: (647) 449-4520

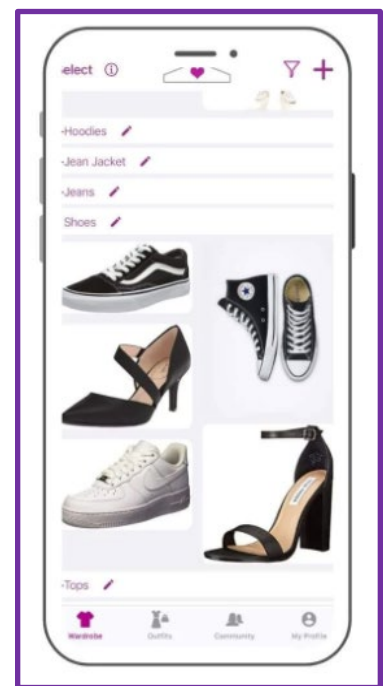
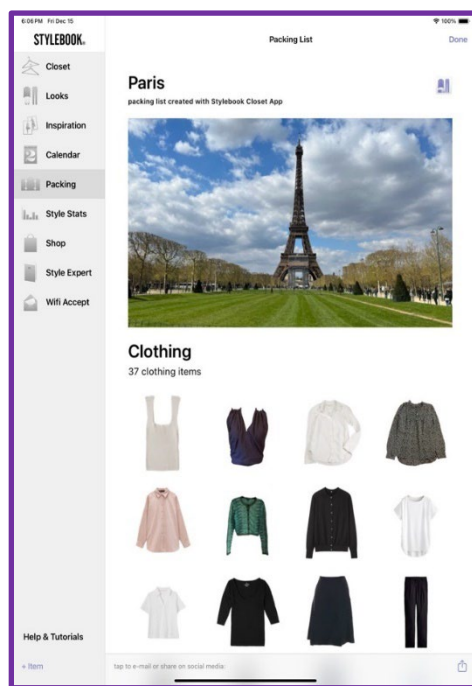
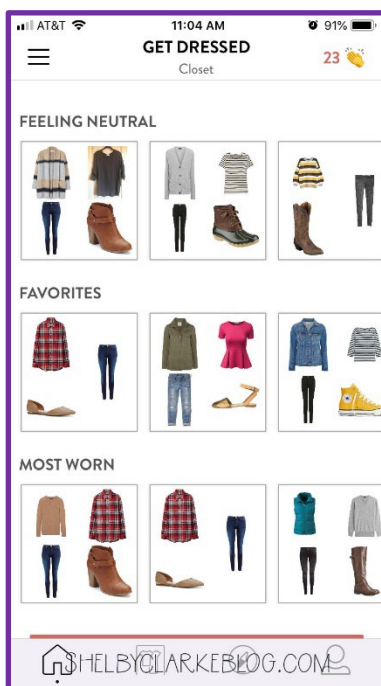
Email: info@eddiedonanteam.ca



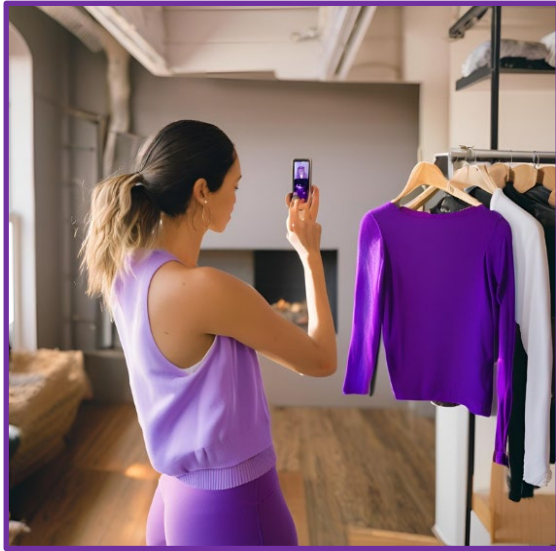
Appendix 3 – Vestium App Example



Appendix 4 – Cladwell, Stylebook, and Pureple App Designs



Appendix 5 – Vestium In Use By Happy Consumers



Appendix 6 – First Class Families PRIZM Market Segmentation Description

05

FIRST-CLASS FAMILIES

Large, well-off suburban families



S1 SUBURBAN ELITE

F2 LARGE DIVERSE FAMILIES

Who They Are

An upscale suburban lifestyle, First-Class Families is characterized by sprawling families—more than 40 percent of households contain four or more people—living in close-in suburbs. More than half the households are located in established neighbourhoods in Toronto, Calgary, Ottawa and Vancouver. In First-Class Families, the parents are middle-aged, the children are 5-24 and nearly 90 percent of households live in pricey, single-family houses. With their solid educations, the adults hold white-collar jobs in management, education and government, and earn incomes that are nearly twice the national average. One quarter of households contain second-generation Canadians; the segment scores high for members for whom Italian, Polish, Greek or Mandarin is their mother tongue. These families enjoy many team sports—baseball, basketball, football, hockey, volleyball—as both participants and spectators. And many families look forward to weekends when they can shop, go out to eat or relax with their tablet to watch Netflix or indulge in e-commerce. Committed to living a healthy and wholesome lifestyle, this group scores high for the value *Effort Toward Health*.

First-Class Families households enjoy the trappings of success. They have the nice house in the suburbs complete with hot tub, home theatre system, landscaped garden and garage filled with boating, golfing and snowboarding equipment. They drive high-end cars equipped with streaming audio and typically own three or more vehicles. The parents spend a lot of their free time chauffeuring their teenage children to athletic activities and stores like Sport Chek and Lululemon Athletica as well as the Gap, Eddie Bauer, Roots and Old Navy. A big splurge in First-Class Families involves a trip to a theme park, waterpark or indoor amusement centre. And everyone relies on tech devices to keep up with their busy schedules—from smartphones and smart watches to voice-activated smart speakers. These time-crunched families routinely skip home-cooked dinners to patronize fast casual restaurants and pizza chains. And as interest in traditional media declines, residents here go online using mobile phones and tablets for a range of activities—from accessing professional sports content and listening to a radio broadcast to researching products and visiting social media sites. Among their favorites: LinkedIn, Twitter, Instagram and Reddit. These family members are most looking forward to being able to attend professional sporting events post-COVID.

How They Think

Members of First-Class Families expect new immigrants and ethnic groups to adopt and blend in with the mainstream culture in Canada (*Cultural Assimilation*). With a strong *Work Ethic*, they believe children should be taught to respect others and work hard to get ahead, but they also think young people should have the same freedoms as adults (*Equal Relationship with Youth*). With their *Emotional Control*, they make decisions based on reason and logic rather than feelings and intuition, which helps them accept the uncertainties of modern life (*Adaptability to Complexity*) and exert *Personal Control* over the direction of their future. They refrain from judging others, preferring not to take sides (*Introspection & Empathy*). But they're passionate about protecting the environment and think everyone has a role to play in the effort (*Ecological Concern*). And despite their affluence and creature comforts, it's still important for them to look good (*Concern for Appearance*). As consumers, they tend to be frugal and motivated by future security (*Saving on Principle*).

Population:
737,286
(1.93% of Canada)

Households:
229,346
(1.53% of Canada)

Average Household Income
\$190,168

Average Household Net Worth:
\$1,255,009

House Tenure:
Own

Education:
University/College/
High School

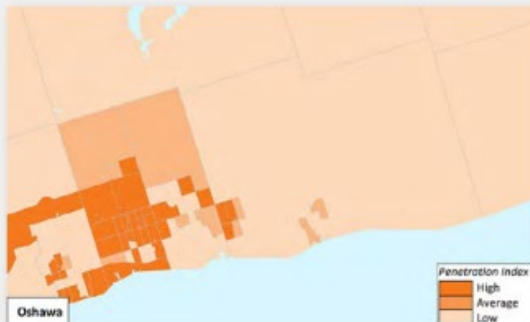
Occupation:
White Collar/Service
Sector

Cultural Diversity Index:
Low

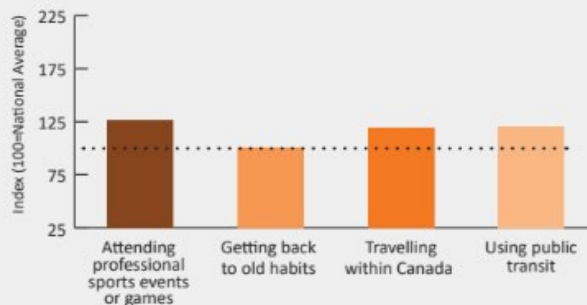
Sample Social Value:
Cultural Assimilation

05. FIRST-CLASS FAMILIES

Where They Live



Post-Pandemic, Looking Forward To:



How They Live



LEISURE

swimming
family movies
theme parks/waterparks/
water slides
museums



TRADITIONAL MEDIA

MLB baseball on TV
CBC News
modern rock radio
Style at Home



FOOD/DRINK

\$250+ spent on groceries/week
sparkling fruit juice
Starbucks
fast casual restaurants



AUTOMOTIVE

intermediate SUVs
European brands
2010-2016 model years
three vehicles



MOBILE

read magazines or newspapers
on mobile phone
fitness trackers
watch movies on tablet
free weather apps



PRIZM



SHOPPING

factory outlet stores
The Children's Place
Old Navy
Home Depot



INTERNET

purchase products or
services online
listen to Internet-only
music service
watch subscription video service
purchase sporting event
tickets online



FINANCIAL

Canada savings bonds
RRSPs
spent \$5,001+/month
on credit cards
group life insurance



SOCIAL

LinkedIn
Instagram
WhatsApp
Reddit



HEALTH

use herbal supplements
for joint health



ATTITUDES

"I can't imagine life without the Internet anymore"

"I have already taken steps to ensure that I have sufficient income for my retirement"

"I always keep informed about the latest technological developments"

"I am willing to pay more for brand-name products"

Appendix 7 – Downtown Verve PRIZM Market Segmentation Description

06

DOWNTOWN VERVE

Younger and middle-aged upscale city dwellers



U1 URBAN ELITE

F1 SCHOOL-AGE FAMILIES

Who They Are

Downtown Verve is a cultural and intellectual hub. Concentrated in a handful of Canada's largest cities, the segment attracts a mix of younger and middle-aged singles, couples and families who prefer the excitement and convenience of downtown living. One of the most educated groups, many residents are first- and second-generation Canadians employed in well-paying management and white-collar positions. They're happy to own or rent in these older urban neighbourhoods, where they're within a few blocks of banks, theatres and dry cleaners. Although their duplexes, row houses, semi-detached houses and low-rise apartments are aging, the average dwelling value is nearly \$900,000—double the national average. With their upscale incomes, their spending power appears even greater because of the significant proportion of singles and childless couples. Living close to entertainment districts, this group has high rates for going to bars, restaurants and cinemas. They also maintain a healthy lifestyle, eating organic food, taking fitness classes and playing racquet sports. With their strong *Ecological Concern*, they believe that the efforts of one person are never too insignificant when it comes to protecting the environment.

The trend-conscious households in Downtown Verve take advantage of their vibrant city settings. They have high rates for going to art galleries, the theatre, jazz concerts, and film and music festivals. Many participate in team sports like baseball, soccer and volleyball. With almost half walking, biking or taking public transit to work, they often stop by coffee shops on their way to work and meet for dinner at ethnic restaurants afterwards. Diet conscious, they like to shop for organic and natural foods at farmers' markets and health food stores. And they're into decorating their residences with ready-to-assemble modern furniture courtesy of Ikea, Structubes and Pier 1 Imports. In Downtown Verve, residents like to vacation abroad, particularly for ski trips, city tours and eco-tourism. But these younger Canadians are most comfortable online, using their computer, mobile phone or tablet to listen to music, read a newspaper, download a movie, send emails and instant messages and buy tickets to all manner of events. With the street scene central to their lifestyle, they're a strong market for out-of-home advertising in bus shelters, subway platforms and train stations. These urbanites are looking forward to using public transit in a post-COVID world.

How They Think

Downtown Verve residents are keen experientialists who thrive in their lively urban world. An independent group, they prefer to go their own way (*Rejection of Authority*) and enjoy taking risks to get the most out of life (*Penchant for Risk*) while distancing themselves from society's standards (*Rejection of Orderliness*). As a younger group, they tend to be tolerant of non-traditional definitions of family (*Flexible Families*) and reject patriarchal relationships in favour of an *Equal Relationship with Youth*. They're also committed to pursuing a healthy and wholesome lifestyle, making a serious *Effort for Health*. These well-educated households are confident in the direction they're going (*Personal Control*), and their *Enthusiasm for Technology* affords them an additional degree of control over their daily routine. Strong on *Global Consciousness* and *Culture Sampling*, these globe-trotting Canadians see themselves as citizens of the world and believe other cultures have a great deal to teach society. As consumers, they distrust advertising as a reliable source of information and take into account the environmental impact of a product or service when making purchase decisions (*Skepticism Towards Advertising*, *Ecological Lifestyle*).

Population:
455,149
(1.19% of Canada)

Households:
184,488
(1.23% of Canada)

Average Household Income
\$179,524

Average Household Net Worth:
\$1,331,350

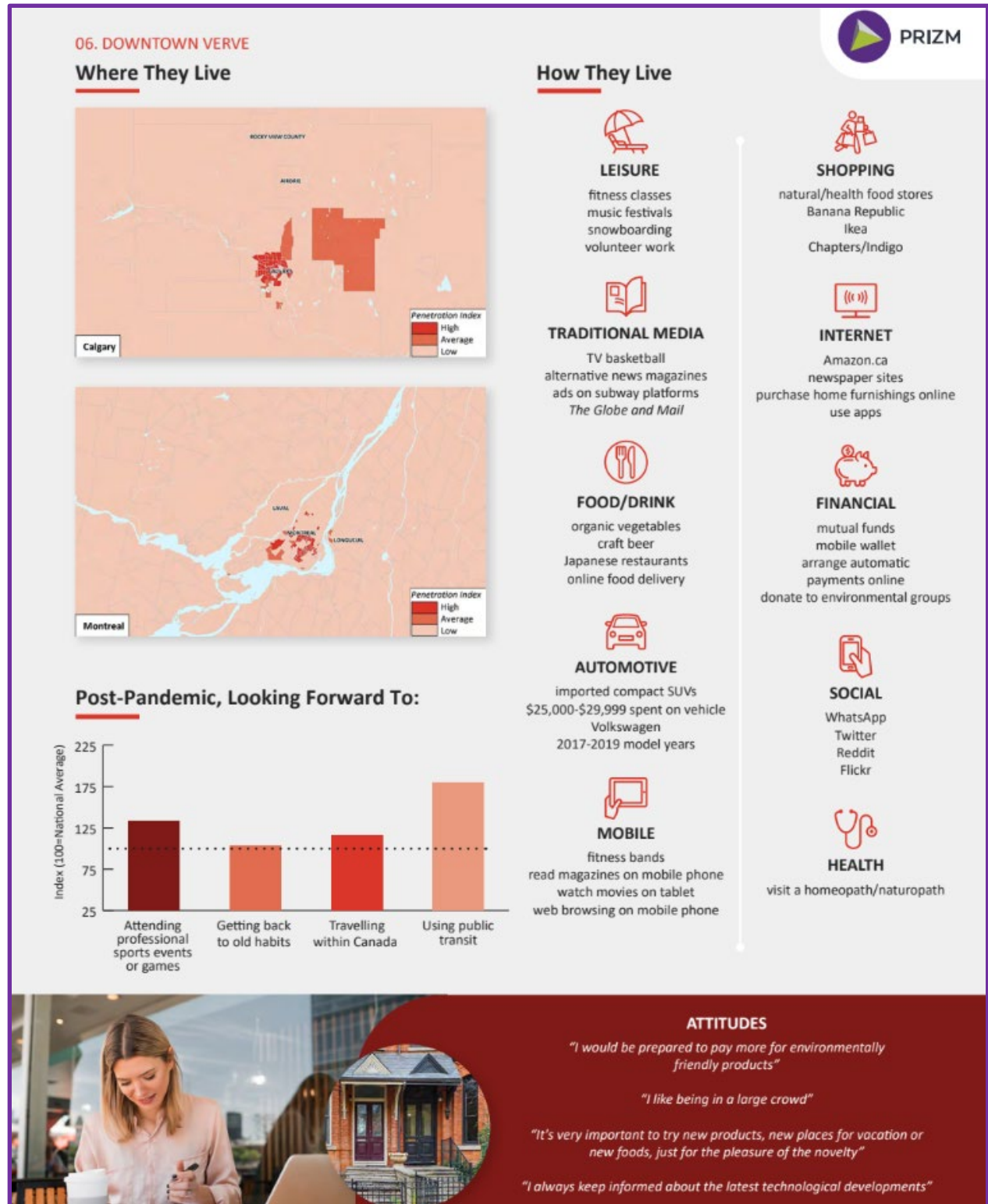
House Tenure:
Own & Rent

Education:
University

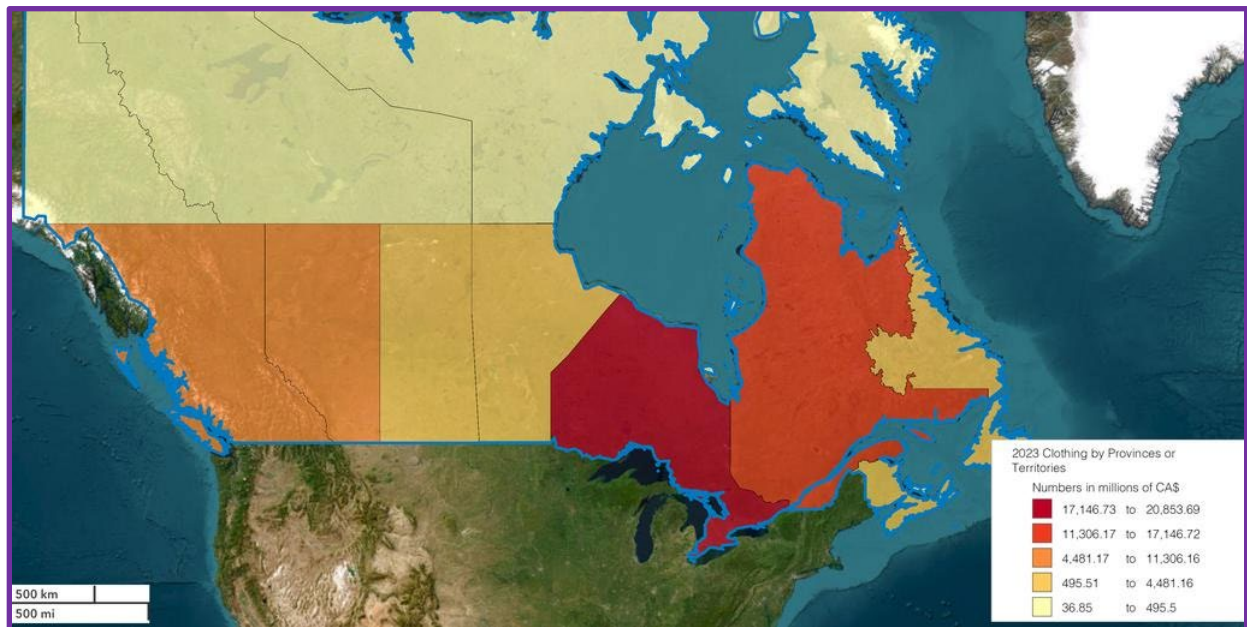
Occupation:
White Collar

Cultural Diversity Index:
Low

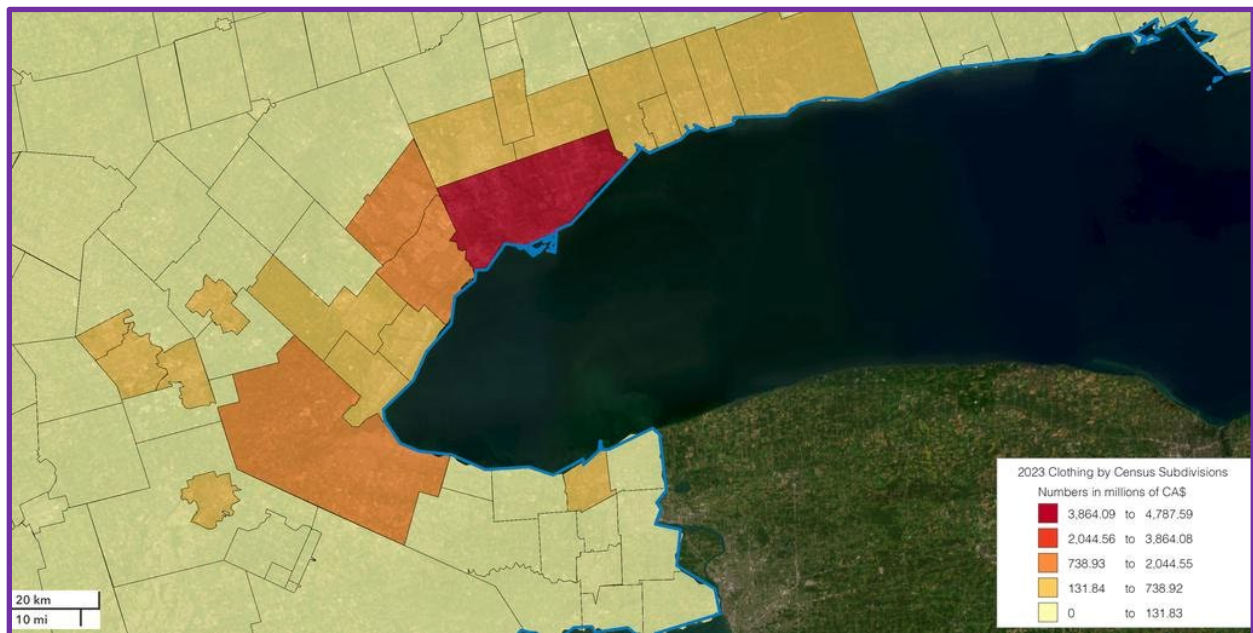
Sample Social Value:
Rejection of Authority



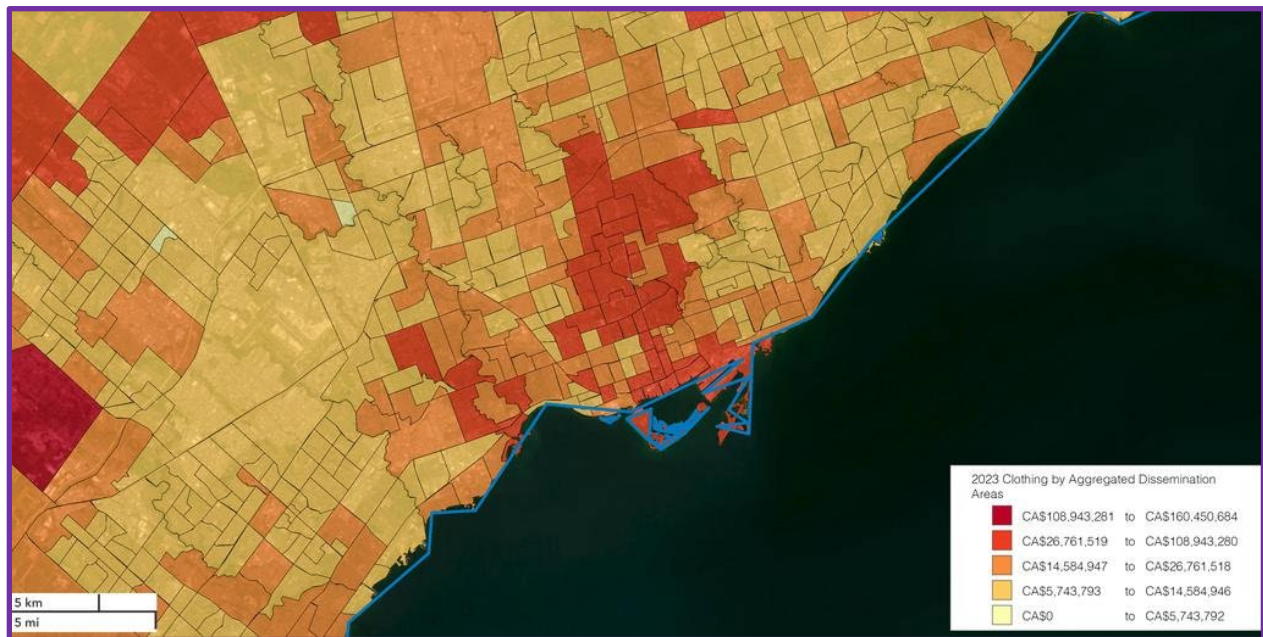
Appendix 8 – Money Spent On Clothing Across Canada In 2023



Appendix 9 – Money Spent On Clothing Across Ontario In 2023



Appendix 10 – Money Spent On Clothing Across The Greater Toronto Area In 2023



Appendix 11 – Expenditures Chart Showcasing Projected Finances

Operating Costs				Profit Streams		Assume 15% annual growth	
				Advertisements		Rev Y1	\$ 393,250.00
Salaries	\$ 150,000.00	/year		Assume 500,000 users		Rev Y2	\$ 452,237.50
App developer salary	\$ 86,736.00	/year		~100,000 daily		Rev Y3	\$ 520,073.13
App Development	\$ 50,000.00	one time		\$50 for ads/day		Rev Y4	\$ 598,084.09
Online marketing	\$ 30,000.00	/year		\$18,250.00		Rev Y5	\$ 687,796.71
Legal	\$ 24,000.00	/year				Rev Y6	\$ 790,966.21
Experiential Marketing	\$ 10,000.00	/use		Purchase Commissions		Rev Y7	\$ 909,611.15
Data storage	\$ 10,000.00	one time		~75,000 Users make purchases		Rev Y8	\$ 1,046,052.82
Consumer Research	\$ 10,000.00	one time		~50\$ Purchases (est 10%)		Rev Y9	\$ 1,202,960.74
App Maintenance	\$ 7,500.00	/year		\$ 375,000.00		Rev Y10	\$ 1,383,404.85
Servers	\$ 5,000.00	one time					
Computers x4	\$ 4,000.00	one time		Total w/ ads			
Internet	\$ 2,400.00	/year		\$ 393,250.00			
Insurance	\$ 1,000.00	/year					
Business registration	\$ 360.00	one time					
App Store Fee	\$ 99.00	/year		Profit Y1	\$ 2,155.00		
HQ Rent	\$ -	/year		Profit Y2	\$ 140,502.50		
Water	\$ -	/year		Profit Y3	\$ 208,338.13		
Electricity	\$ -	/year		Profit Y4	\$ 286,349.09		
Total Costs Y1	\$ 391,095.00			Profit Y5	\$ 376,061.71		
Total Costs Y2 +	\$ 311,735.00			Profit Y6	\$ 479,231.21		
				Profit Y7	\$ 597,876.15		
				Profit Y8	\$ 734,317.82		
				Profit Y9	\$ 891,225.74		
				Profit Y10	\$ 1,071,669.85		

Appendix 12 – Vestium Logo And Slogan



Appendix 13 – In-App Advertisement Example



Appendix 14 – Experiential Marketing Mock Up



Appendix 15 – Vestium Press Release**PRESS RELEASE**
FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

November 20, 2024

**INNOVATIVE APP VESTIUM TO BE SHOWCASED AT TORONTO'S EATON CENTRE.**

Toronto, ON: Today, Vestium, an innovative company that allows users to create digital collections of their wardrobes on their phones by simply taking a picture has announced that they will be opening a booth at Toronto's Eaton Centre. After recently launching their incredible free service, they are eager to show their productive app to the masses.

In a statement by their COO Miraj Siddiqui, "Vestium will have this pop up running for 2 weeks during Eaton Centre Mall operating hours. This initiative will allow shoppers the ability to come and interact with our product, and get any questions they may have answered". The company says that they will instruct individuals how to download and utilize the app at this site, and show neat tips and tricks to help you snap into style. Additionally, Vestium has said that they hope this maneuver will increase the number of users and draw attention to their promising app. Current users of the app have shared tremendous insights on the app. Micheal Sim, a professional volleyball player said, "Wowzaal This app really helped me dress to impress". The statement of Jeff LaForge, a political figure, echoes Sim's sentiments with his fine words being, "hands down - this app is fricken amazing." Outside of the province, a Quebecian by the name of Carolyn Bilton shares, "Ooh lala, this app makes me stand out at the staff parties". Clearly, this app has got the buzz.

To gain all of this attraction, the app leverages ultra smart artificial intelligence algorithms and processes. So, when you snap a picture of your favorite shirt, it loads this into your personal closet in the app. From here, if you prompt it to give you an outfit to match a certain occasion, the AI will don upon you a fitting outfit based upon what you have in your personal closet.

What shoppers at the Eaton Centre from February 16th to March 1st can expect from Vestium's booth:

- Excellent staff support and guidance to field questions
- Interaction with the app and seeing how it works
- Aid in setting it up on their personal device
- Tips and tricks to use the app as effectively as possible

About Vestium: Vestium was founded in 2024. It is the creator of an app that integrates fashion and technology together. It's goal is to reduce global fashion waste and overconsumption by proving to users the capability of their closets. It does this by allowing users to upload images of their clothing, by which the app organizes it into their closet. Later on, when a user enters a prompt and asks for an outfit, the AI algorithm will intake what is in the closet of the user and put together an outfit that meets the desires of the individual.

###

Yours Sincerely,
Miraj Siddiqui
Vestium Representative



647-272-6950
VestiumPress@Vestium.ca
Unit 4 - 117 Wellington St. East
Aurora, Ontario L4G1H9.

Appendix 16 – CEO Ethan Fleming’s Resume



ETHAN FLEMING

CEO of Vestium

PROFILE

Ethan's distinct value is his ability to lead with authority and confidence. He delivers this by setting high standards, motivating through a competitive spirit and being conscientious of the details. He does this so he can follow through on his commitments, deliver on time and make decisions that create win-win solutions for all at the table.

CONTACT

PHONE:
+1 905 717 8593

EMAIL:
ethan.fleming@sac.on.ca

229 Earl Stewart Dr,
Aurora, ON, L4G 7Y3

EDUCATION

St. Andrew's College
Gr.6 – Gr 12 (Present)

- Head Prefect of the school
- Inter-Faith Council, Student Head
- Duke Of Edinburgh Award Group Leader
- Stuart B. Wood Memorial Prize
- Montgomery Scholarship

WORK EXPERIENCE (OUTSIDE OF VESTIUM)

St. Andrew's College, Head Prefect
September 2024 - Present
Lead a group of thirteen other prefects through organizing full school events, running assemblies, and improving student life. Mediate conversations, plan meetings, and speak at full school events.

S.A.C. Summer Camp, Camp Counsellor
June 2023 - Present
Managed group of campers by making sure everyone is safe and accounted for, running activities, and ensuring everyone is having fun. Mediated behaviour of the group, resolving disputes between campers, and collaborated with other counsellors to maintain a fun camp environment and to manage the group.

Aurora-King Baseball Association, Umpire
June 2018 - Present
Responsible for ensuring the safety of players and ensuring the rules of baseball are being followed and fairly enforced. Also responsible for discussing game decisions with coaches and mediating behaviour of coaches/parents/players if acting inappropriately.

SKILLS

- Leadership
- Communication
- Interpersonal Skills

Appendix 17 – COO Miraj Siddiqui's Resume

MIRAJ SIDDIQUI

COO of Vestium

PROFILE

Miraj's distinct value is his ability to build connections and strong relationships. He delivers this by leading through confident decision making and forward moving action. He does this so that he can elevate the status quo, exceed expectations and push for success in performance, results and impact.

CONTACT

PHONE:
+1 647 272 7880

EMAIL:
mirajsiddiqui14@gmail.com

247 Northern Pines Blvd,
Kleinburg, ON, L4H 4E5

EDUCATION

St. Andrew's College

Gr.6 – Gr 12 (Present)

- Prefect of the school
- Head of Ambassador Program
- Muslim Student Association Head
- McEwan Business Leadership Award
- English Award

WORK EXPERIENCE (OUTSIDE OF VESTIUM)

MediOne Focal Pharmacy, Pharmacy Assistant

June 2023 - Present

Entails sorting and organizing drugs, aid in filling orders, observe compounding, communicating and working with patients, as well as observing processes that occur in a pharmacy.

Mackenzie Richmond Hill Hospital, Gift Shop Associate

Summer of 2023

Experience entailed assisting customers of all capabilities, working the cash register as well as stocking and labeling products for sale.

Lisa's Cosmetics, Floor Assistant

April 2023–May 2023

The brief sale included me constantly interacting with customers, working in and around the cash register as well as performing carry outs and taking items to the cars of customers.

Copper Creek Golf Course, Golf Services

Summer of 2022

Job entailed organizing and cleaning carts, directing players to areas of play, welcoming players to the course and helping with other various tasks on the golf course.

SKILLS

- Interpersonal Skills
- Persistence
- Passion

Appendix 18 – CFO Liam Milenov’s Resume

LIAM MILENOV

CFO of Vestium

PROFILE

My distinct value is to lead with authority and confidence, Setting high standards, motivating through a competitive spirit and being conscientious of the details, while building strong personal connections by bringing the human touch through empathetic listening and authentic communication

CONTACT

PHONE:
+1 289 988 8450

EMAIL:
liam.milenov@sac.on.ca

54 Campbell Drive
Uxbridge ON, L9P0B2

EDUCATION

St. Andrew's College

Gr.9 – Gr 12 (Present)

- Cadet Commanding Officer
- President of Student Life Council
- President of Debate Society
- President of Chess Club
- Grade 11 Law Award

WORK EXPERIENCE (OUTSIDE OF VESTIUM)

Office Assistant – Axis Chiropractic

2022-2023

Kept the office organized to improve functionality and efficiency and adapted to changing COVID-19 safety protocols during the pandemic with strict adherence to all health and safety guidelines to help keep patients and staff safe.

Assistant Instructor – Uxbridge Taekwondo Academy

2013-2020

Upholding P.R.I.D.E. (Perseverance, Respect, Integrity, Dedication, Endurance), led classes and took on a leadership role to help younger members of the academy, demonstrated ability to be patient and creative by changing teaching methods to suit individual learning styles, encouraged younger students to maintain focus and discipline while training, earned my black belt after 7 years of training

Sales Associate – Canadian Tire

2022 - Present

Assisting customers with different needs including product location, recommendation, and marketing, maintaining a well-ordered store, collaborating with co-workers and superiors

SKILLS

- Interpersonal Communication
- Ambition
- Competitiveness

Appendix 19 – CTO John Qing's Resume



118 John Button Blvd, Markham, ON
L3R9C2
(437)-219-6906
John.Qing123@gmail.com

Xinyang Qing

I am interested in and have worked on projects within the fields of software and computer engineering such as backend development, competitive coding, circuit design, PCB design and creation. I prefer hands-on electrical engineering work and creating complex projects that involve many different aspects and elements of electrical, computer, and software engineering.

Previous Projects

- Python Backend Webserver Frameworks with Flask.
- Python Web scraping project.
- Python HTTP API project
- Line sensor PCB
- IR Locator PCB
- Motor Driver PCB
- Edge Impulse & Python-implemented AI Image Recognition
- Interfacing with many different types of Sensors in Arduino

Skills

- PCB & Circuit Design
- High-level Python and programming concepts understanding
- Understanding of HTTP and the IoT
- Using OpenCV with Python
- Basic 3D modelling
- Understanding of basic signal technology and processing

2023
Canadian Representative at Robocup Worlds 2023&2024
Team Captain
Represented Canada at the Lightweight Soccer Robocup Junior Worlds in Bordeaux, France. Worked with Arduino-based microcontrollers and interfacing sensors, surface mount and through-hole soldering, python Edge Impulse AI image recognition, C++ programming in Arduino, and PCB and sensor circuitry design as well as integration of MCUs into PCBs.

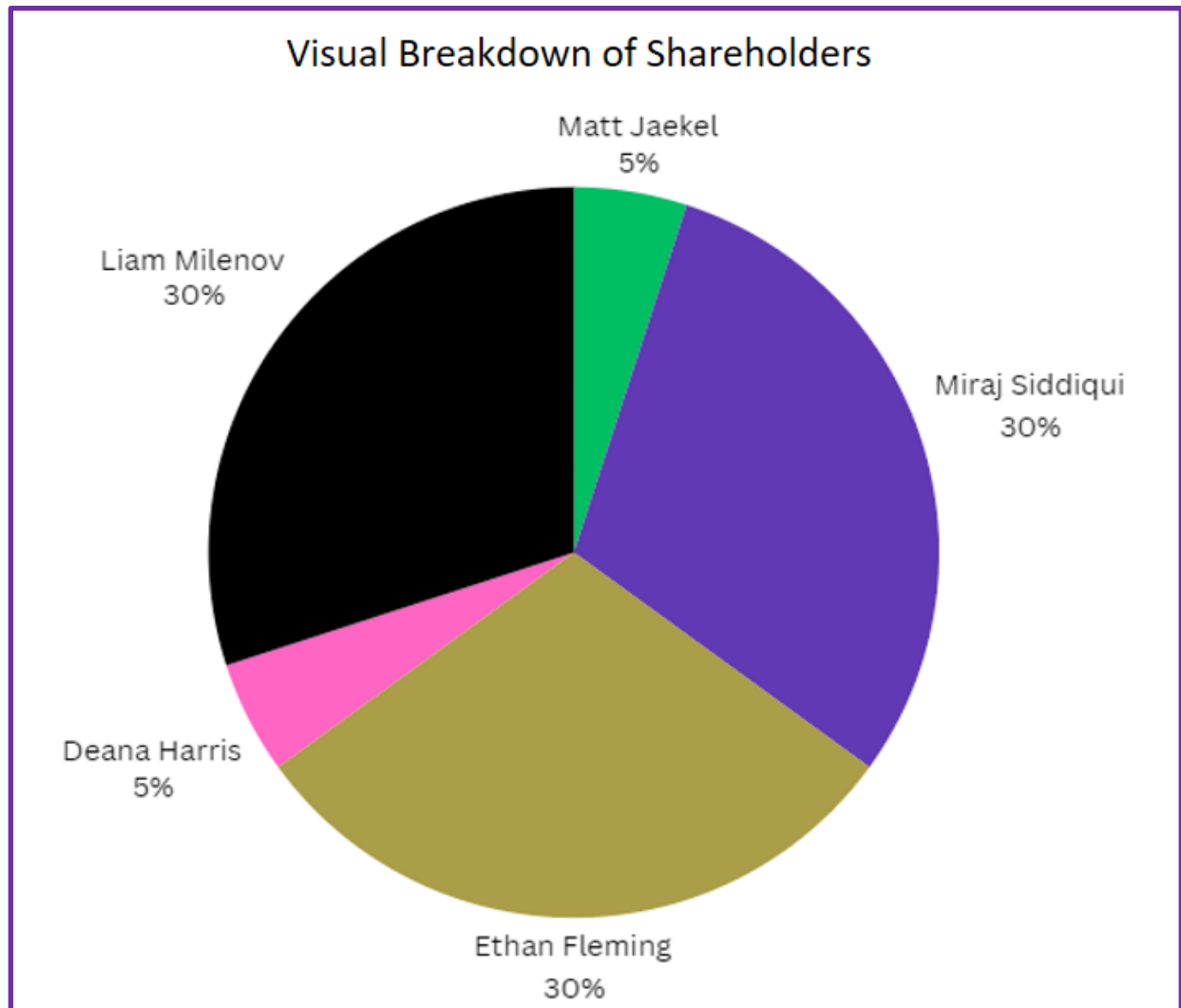
2023-2024
VEX Robotics Competition, Team Lead, 97779A
Team Captain
Led the school VEX Robotics Competition Team. Worked with C++ code, GitHub Version Control, team management, mechanical engineering, and basic pneumatics systems.

2022-2023
Canadian Robocup National Champions – York Region Competition
Team Captain
Won the qualifying national-level tournament for Lightweight Soccer in Aurora, Ontario. Worked with C++ programming in Arduino, interfacing with prebuilt Arduino sensors, 3D design, through-hole soldering, and using prebuilt motor drivers.

2023-2024
Raised Edge Inc., Best Seat in the House Inc.
Part-Time Office IT Manager
Worked with troubleshooting, computer hardware, networking and dealing with the Windows Operating system. Working with upgrading the office technology systems.

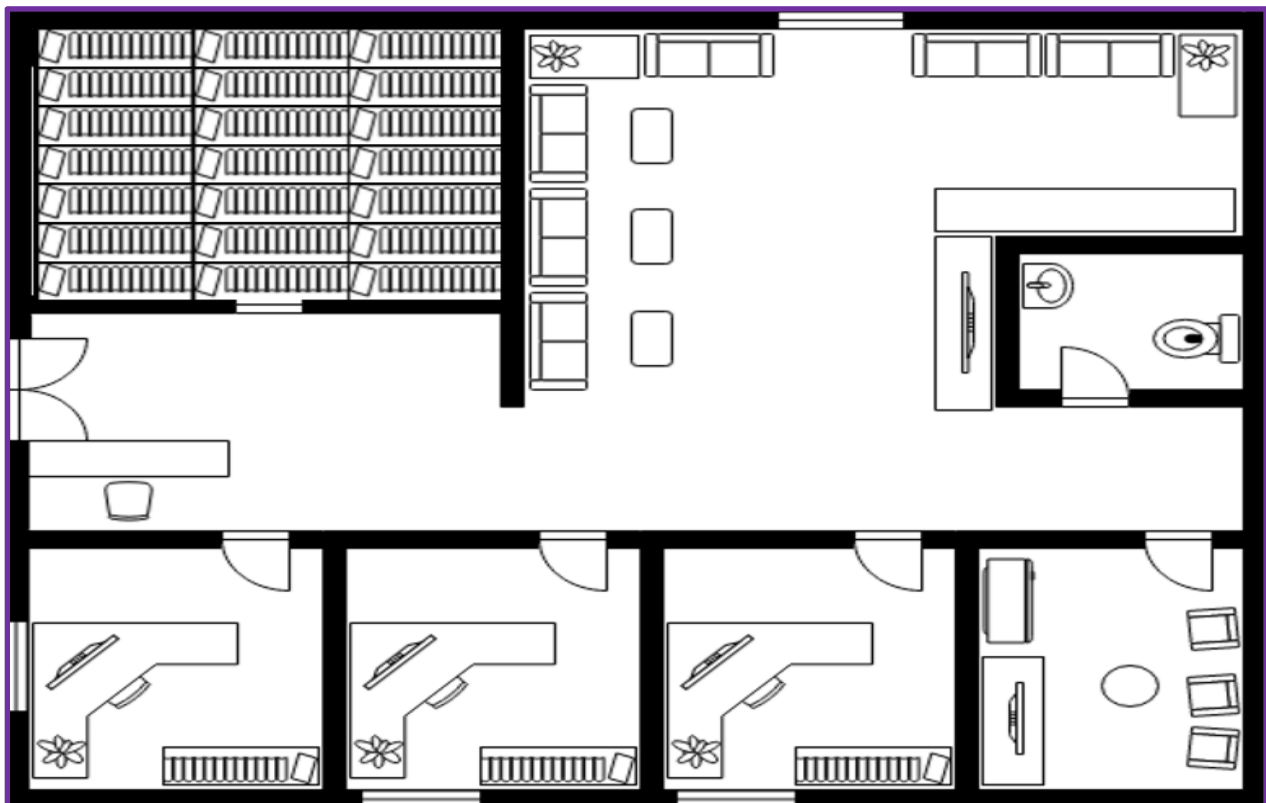


Appendix 20 – Visual Breakdown Of Shareholders

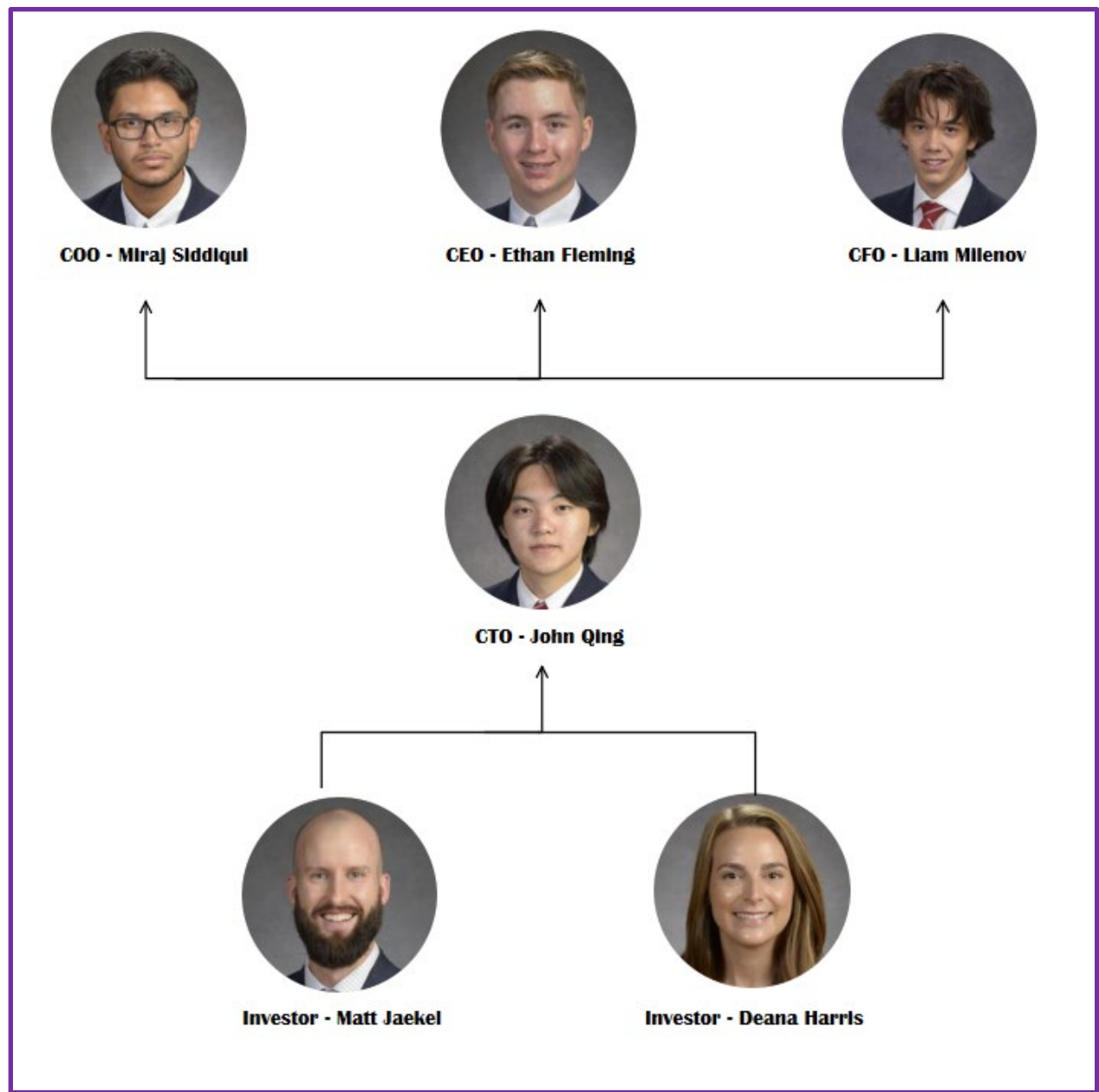


Appendix 21 – Vestium Office Photos And Layout





Appendix 22 – Vestium Organizational Structure Chart



Appendix 23 – Operating Costs

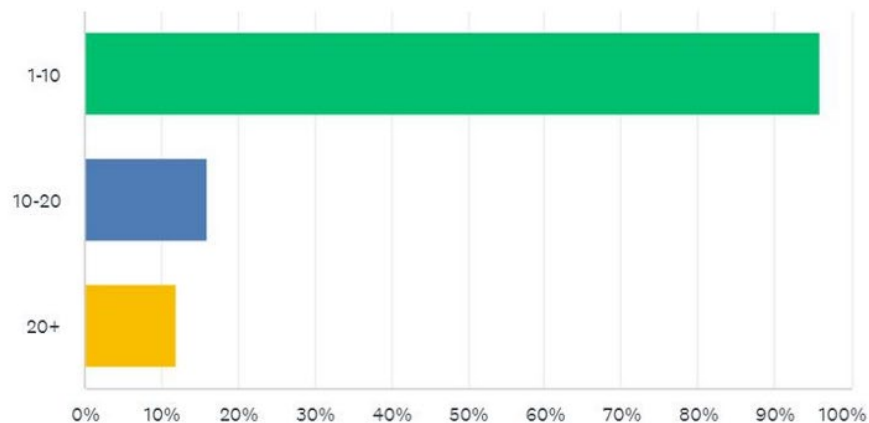
Operating Costs		
Salaries	\$ 150,000.00	/year
App developer salary	\$ 86,736.00	/year
App Development	\$ 50,000.00	one time
Online marketing	\$ 30,000.00	/year
Legal	\$ 24,000.00	/year
Loan Payback	\$ 20,000.00	/year
HQ Rent	\$ 10,200.00	/year
Experiential Marketing	\$ 10,000.00	/use
Data storage	\$ 10,000.00	one time
Consumer Research	\$ 10,000.00	one time
App Maintenance	\$ 7,500.00	/year
Servers	\$ 5,000.00	one time
Computers x4	\$ 4,000.00	one time
Internet	\$ 2,400.00	/year
Insurance	\$ 1,000.00	/year
Business registration	\$ 360.00	one time
App Store Fee	\$ 99.00	/year
Total Costs Y1	\$ 421,295.00	
Total Costs Y2 +	\$ 321,935.00	

Appendix 24 – Break Even Analysis

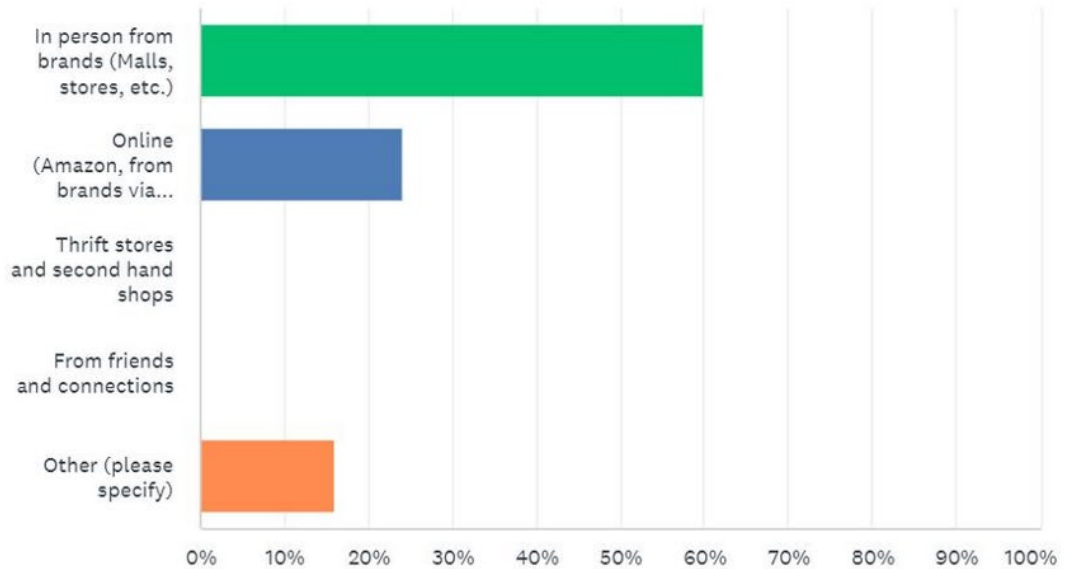
Year 2 (Monthly)			
	January:	February:	March:
Monthly Net Profit:	\$ 10,858.54	\$10,858.54	\$10,858.54
Total:	-\$17,186.46	-\$6,327.92	\$4,530.62

Appendix 25 – Consumer Interest Survey Results

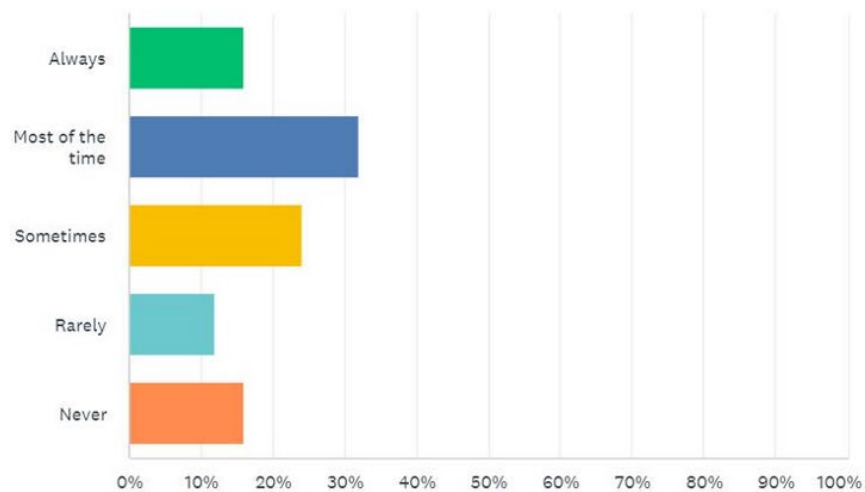
How many articles (1 shirt, 1 pant, 1 jacket, etc.) of clothing do you purchase each month on average?



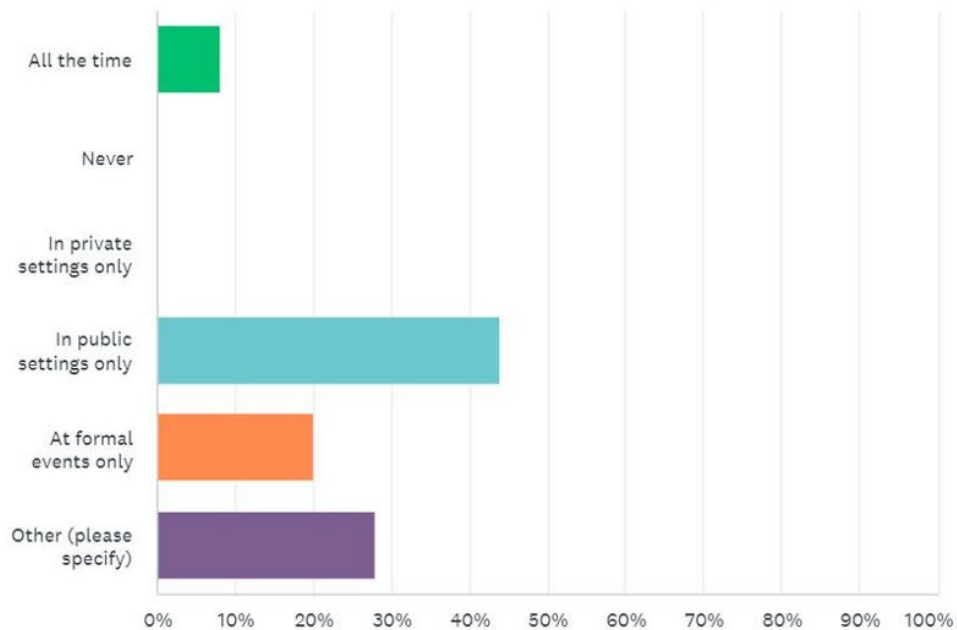
Where do you usually buy your clothes from?



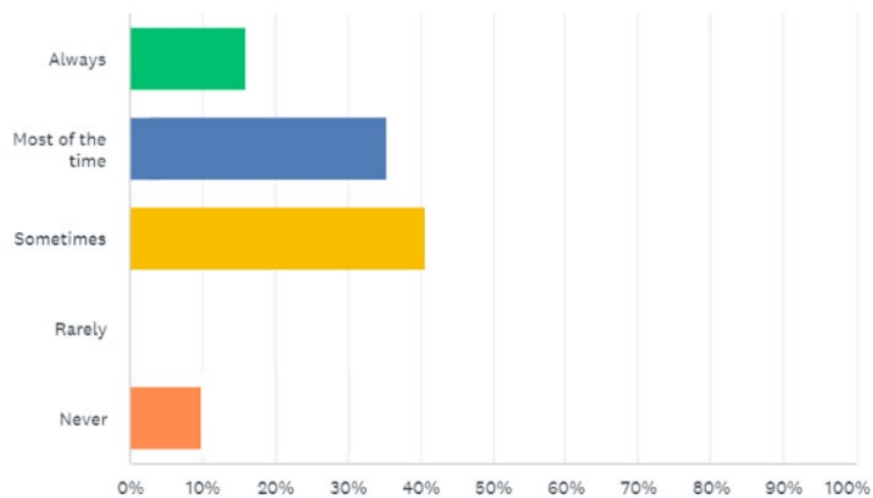
How often do you care about the appearance of your clothing in front of other people?



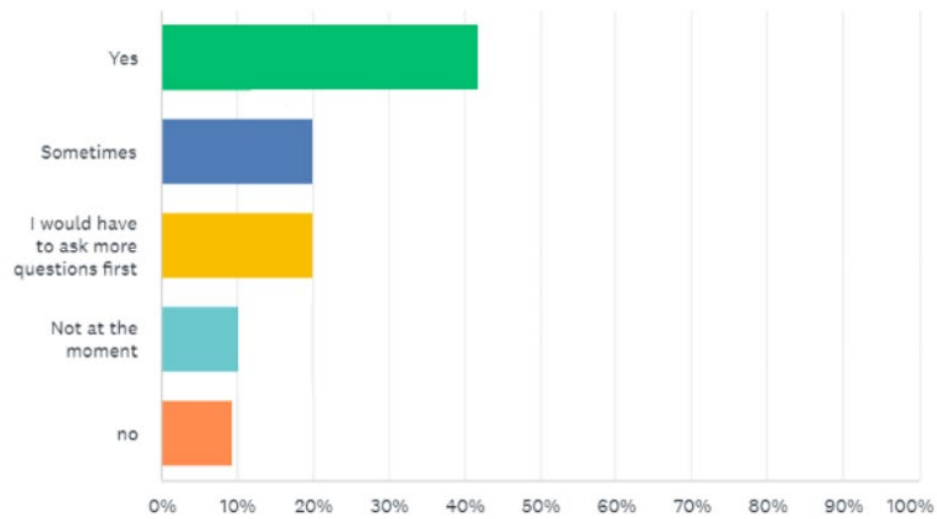
Where do you care about the appearance of your clothing in front others?



How often do you think about the social impact of overconsumption and fast fashion of a brand before purchasing clothing from them?



In general, would you use Vestium. Furthermore, if you have any additional questions before making your decision, please speak to a Vestium representative (Ethan Fleming, Miraj Siddiqui, or Liam Milenov).



Appendix 26 – Vestium Business Cards





Acknowledgements:

Vestium would like to thank Mr. Sean Ludwig, Mr. John Qing, Ms. Ellen Martin, Mr. Giancarlo Trimarchi, and Ms. Diane Craig for their contributions, support, and advice throughout the process of launching our company. Additionally, Vestium cannot begin to express its immense gratitude towards Mr. Robert McEwen for continuing to fund and support the McEwen Business Program at St. Andrew's College, which without, this report would not have been possible.

